

DeskPRO Admin Manual

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1. Introducing DeskPRO

Welcome to DeskPRO, the helpdesk software platform.

This manual explains the details of how to install, configure and manage a DeskPRO helpdesk as an **admin**.

If you just need to know how to help users as an **agent**, please see our [Agent Quick Start Guide](#). If you are new to DeskPRO, we suggest you read the Agent Quick Start Guide before reading this manual.

1.1. Helpdesk basics

If you're completely new to the concept of helpdesk software, you might be wondering why anybody needs a dedicated helpdesk platform like DeskPRO.

Companies that need to manage user issues - whether that's handling complaints from external customers, or IT help requests from colleagues - often start out trying to do it all with email.

The problem with this approach is that email is just not a good tool for tracking issues. If all your support email goes to a single address, it's hard to keep track of who is dealing with which issue; but if each of your staff uses a personalized address, what happens if the staff member who has been dealing with an important client falls sick or leaves the company?

And how do you keep track when a user sends emails from two different addresses, or two people from the same company are chasing the same issue independently?

DeskPRO helps you track issues with **tickets** - each ticket denotes a question, problem or complaint associated with a user. A ticket is a way to tie together everything you know about an issue - all the messages passed between your helpdesk and the user and internally between your agents, which agent or team is dealing with it, whether the user is waiting for a reply or you're waiting to hear back from them, how urgent it is, and so on.

Messages users send by email or via the web are automatically converted into tickets in DeskPRO's web-based agent interface. Agents write replies from the interface and DeskPRO automatically emails them to the user.

1.2. DeskPRO features and benefits

We've worked hard to make DeskPRO **powerful yet simple**. We understand that to be accepted by your agents, our software has to be intuitive and pleasant to use, but powerful enough that it enhances their productivity rather than holding them back.

We've carried the principle of "powerful yet simple" to the administration of the platform, as well. It's easy to set up a working helpdesk in minutes, you can then configure it to match your business processes instead of changing the way you work.

Here are some of the key benefits of DeskPRO:

Flexible configuration: you can arrange your helpdesk using teams and departments to reflect how your company works, or add your own completely custom fields. You can configure fine-grained access permissions to control what agents and users can see.

Automation: DeskPRO supports powerful conditional actions called triggers and escalations, which you can set up with a simple web interface. You can customize any of the default automatic actions using the same system.

Agents can speed up their workflow with snippets (shortcuts to enter common pieces of text) and macros, which automate repetitive sets of actions.

Branding: you can fully customize the web portal and embed it into your website, or integrate some DeskPRO features (like live chat) into your website using widgets.

Extensibility: We refer to DeskPRO as a platform because it can be extended using DeskPRO apps. We offer authentication apps to allow users to sign in to DeskPRO with credentials from other services, and full apps which integrate functions from third-party services into your helpdesk.

You can customize the agent interface by writing simple widgets using just HTML and Javascript, or write your own apps with our REST API.

1.3. DeskPRO terminology

Before we go any further, here are a few key terms and concepts you need to understand to configure DeskPRO.

Users: people who need help and support from your helpdesk, whether that is external customers or others within your enterprise (for example if you're running an IT helpdesk)

Agent: someone within your enterprise who helps users

Team: a team is a group of agents; you can assign a ticket to a team instead of an individual agent, so teams are usually made of agents who work together closely and could all answer the same type of ticket

Department: departments are a way to divide up the helpdesk and control access. They usually reflect different sections of your enterprise, for example 'Support' and 'Sales'.

Agent interface: the web interface that **agents** use to get their work done. When you have set up your helpdesk, it will be at http://YOUR_HELPDESK_ADDRESS/agent

Admin interface: the web interface that you will use to configure the helpdesk and check that it is working correctly. It will be at http://YOUR_HELPDESK_ADDRESS/admin

Web portal: this is an optional way to allow users to interact with the help desk through the web; depending on how you choose to configure it, users can view their tickets, submit feedback, see knowledgebase articles, etc. If enabled, it will be accessible to users at http://YOUR_HELPDESK_ADDRESS/

2. Creating Your Helpdesk

There are two hosting options for DeskPRO:

- **DeskPRO Cloud:** where the software runs on our servers, and we manage the technical details of hardware, upgrades, off-site backups, network and bandwidth. This is the quickest and easiest method, and it's what we recommend for most customers.
- **DeskPRO Download:** where you download and install DeskPRO on your own servers. This gives you more control over your data and reduces your reliance on third parties. You have full access to the DeskPRO source code. You will need to be able to maintain the servers, and arrange hosting and bandwidth.

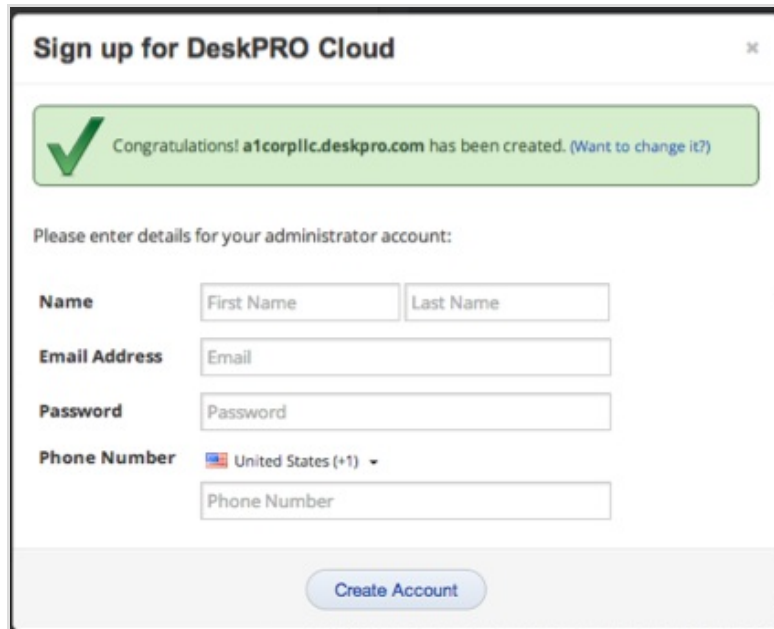
Note that you can always migrate between these two options at no extra cost, so you can evaluate DeskPRO using Cloud, then move your helpdesk to your own servers later.

Even if you are using Cloud, you can configure DeskPRO so that both the agent interface and the portal are accessed through a custom domain - i.e. instead of `yourcompany.deskpro.com`, your users see the portal at `support.yourcompany.com` and your agents log in at `support.yourcompany.com/agent`.

2.1. Cloud sign-up

Creating a Cloud helpdesk is easy:

- 1 Go to <https://www.deskpro.com/pricing/> and enter a name for your helpdesk.
- 2 The **Sign up for DeskPRO Cloud** pop-up opens. Enter the details for your admin account.



The screenshot shows a pop-up window titled "Sign up for DeskPRO Cloud". At the top, a green banner with a checkmark icon says "Congratulations! a1corp11c.deskpro.com has been created. (Want to change it?)". Below this, the text "Please enter details for your administrator account:" is displayed. The form contains several input fields: "Name" (split into "First Name" and "Last Name"), "Email Address" (labeled "Email"), "Password", "Phone Number" (with a dropdown menu showing "United States (+1)" and a "Phone Number" input field), and a "Create Account" button at the bottom.

- 3 You can now log in with the email address and password you provided.

2.2. Download installation

Setting up a Download helpdesk is *fairly* easy, but it does require some server and database administration skills on your platform of choice.

DeskPRO Download is web-based software written in the PHP language. It is designed to be independent of the underlying operating system, so will run on any recent version of Windows, Linux or Mac OS X.

DeskPRO requires the following:

A webserver: we recommend a recent version of Apache or Microsoft IIS; however, any web server that works well with PHP should be able to run DeskPRO.

PHP: minimum supported version is v5.3.2, but we recommend always using the latest version.

DeskPRO will also need access to the command line version of PHP (often called php or php-cli on Linux or php-win.exe on Windows). This is generally installed by default on any server with PHP installed.

PHP extensions that you need enabled are:

- PDO with the MySQL driver installed
- mbstring or iconv
- json
- session
- ctype
- dom
- tokenizer
- GD or Imagick or Gmagick
- OpenSSL (recommended)

It is recommended, but not required, that you install an **opcode cache** such as [Alternative PHP Cache](#) or [Windows Cache Extension](#), which can dramatically increase performance.

mySQL database: The minimum supported version is 5.0; we recommend always using the latest 5.x.x. version.

cron (on a Unix-based OS) or **Scheduled Tasks** (on Windows) to run regular processes such as sending email

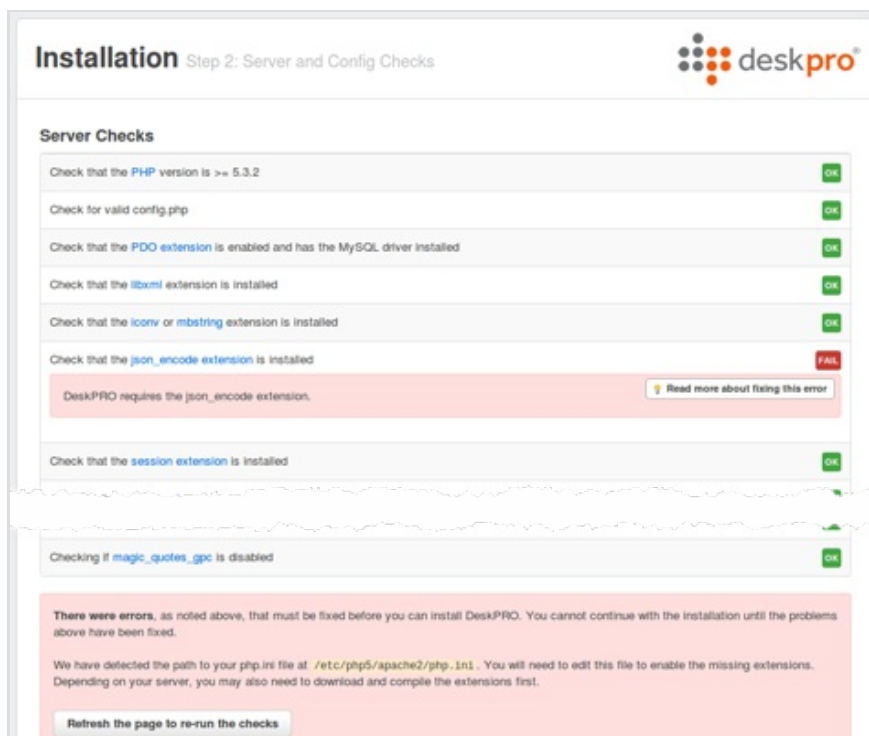
An email server: DeskPRO can send email via an SMTP server or using the PHP mail() function. It can receive email from a server using the standard POP3 protocol. Instead of running your own mail server, you can use the email features of a Google Apps account.

Hardware: DeskPRO runs well on modest hardware, and can easily run from a standard virtual machine or even virtual hosting account. If you are expecting a very busy helpdesk, the limiting factor for speed is generally the database, which can be helped by increasing the amount of RAM and using fast disks for storage. You can run all the required software on one machine; however, you may wish to separate the web server from the database server.

We can't provide a step-by-step guide for every possible combination of operating system, version and configuration. However, DeskPRO has an installation wizard which will check your server environment and tell you what steps you need to take to complete the install.

The installation process generally runs like this:

- 1 Install a webserver and enable PHP support and URL rewriting.
- 2 Install PHP, with the PHP extensions listed above.
- 3 Install MySQL, and create a 'deskpro' user account.
- 4 Download the latest version of DeskPRO from <https://www.deskpro.com/downloads/deskpro.zip>
 - remove the default page (e.g. `index.html`) from your web server's base directory, and unzip `deskpro.zip` into it
 - copy the resulting `config.new.php` file as `config.php`
 - set a cron job or Scheduled Task to run `cron.php` once per minute
 - edit `config.php` to add your email address and MySQL database credentials
- 5 Ensure the webserver is running and go to the URL (or IP address) where it is serving DeskPRO.
- 6 The wizard will then take you through the required steps to complete installation.


- 7 Once installation is complete, you can log on with the account details you gave during installation.

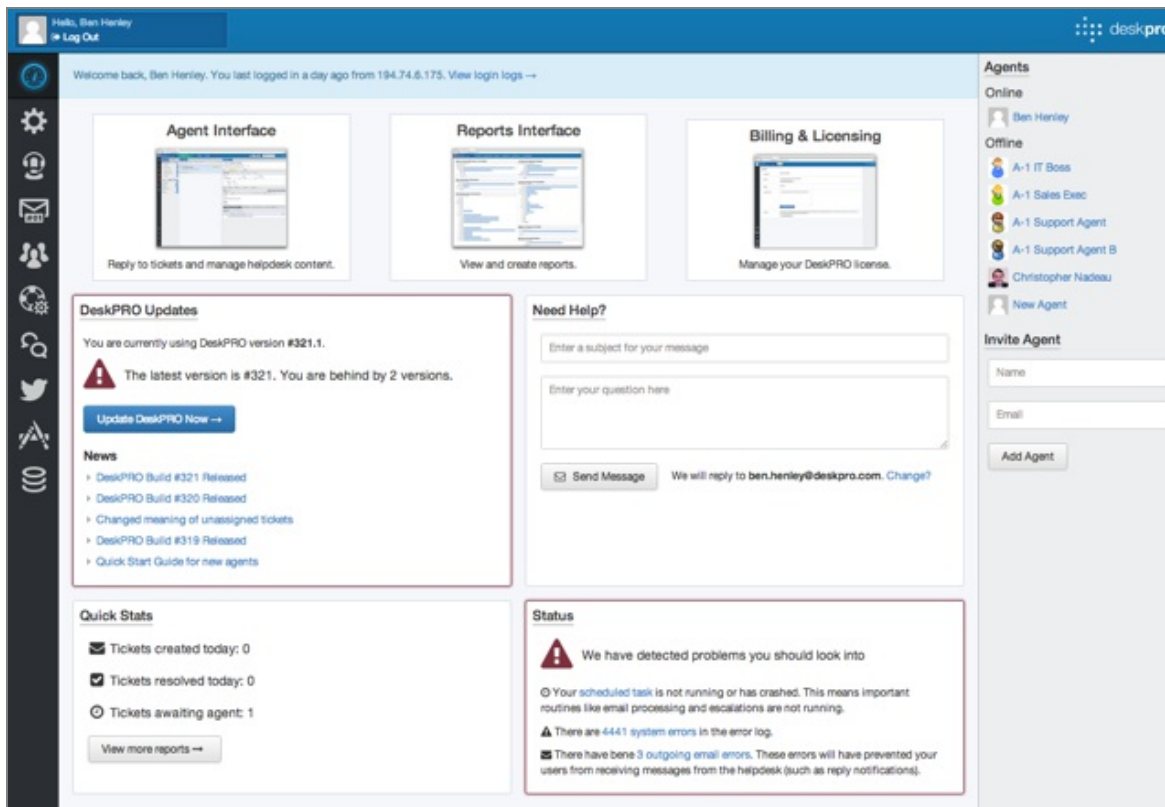
You may be able to find more detailed installation advice for your platform in our knowledgebase at <https://support.deskpro.com/kb>. If you need more help, we also offer an [Installation service](#).

3. Configuring Your Helpdesk

Once your helpdesk has been created, you will be able to log in to the admin interface.

DeskPRO configuration is very flexible, but in this chapter we'll walk through the basic first steps that almost every helpdesk will need.

The admin home page gives you an overview of the status of your DeskPRO installation.



The icons in the bar at the far left give you access to different admin sections - from top to bottom:

- Setup
- Agents
- Tickets
- CRM
- Portal
- Chat
- Twitter
- Apps
- Server

At the top of the home page are links to the other interfaces within DeskPRO:

- the **agent** interface where agents reply to tickets - see the Agent Manual for more details
- the **reports** interface where you can produce detailed statistics and graphs about agent performance
- the **billing & licensing** interface where you manage your DeskPRO license

Note that you don't need to make yourself a separate agent account to use the agent interface: any **admin** account (like the one you're using now) is automatically an agent.

3.1. Initial customization

The first step to configuring your helpdesk is to customize it with details of your enterprise.

Go to the **Setup** section by clicking the gear icon in the left-hand bar.



Enter the details requested under **Your Helpdesk** and **Your Website**.

Settings

Your Helpdesk

Helpdesk Name

This is the name of your helpdesk. The name is displayed to users in their browser window title, and is also

Helpdesk URL

The primary URL for your helpdesk. This URL is used whenever the system needs to link to your helpdesk.

Your Website

Website Name

Enter the name of your company or company website.

Website URL

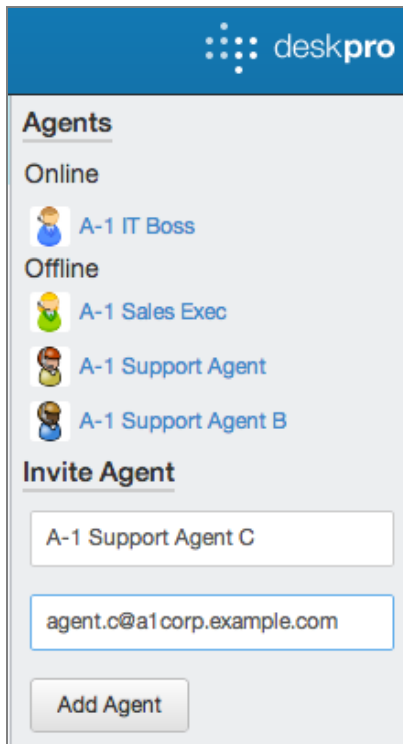
Enter the URL to your company website.

The **Helpdesk URL** entry should be the address of the web portal.

While you're on this page, check that the **Default Timezone** at the top of the **Dates and Times** section is set correctly.

3.2. Create some agents

You can see the list of agents in the system at the top right of the home page.



Initially, you will only see your account.

You can quickly add your colleagues as new agents using **Invite Agent**, just by entering the new agent's name and email, then clicking **Add Agent**.

The person will get an email notification about their new agent account, with the [Agent Quick Start Guide](#) (a brief overview of how the agent interface works) attached.

You can create and manage agents in more detail from the **Agents** section.

The screenshot shows the 'Properties' tab of the DeskPRO agent configuration interface. At the top, there are tabs for 'Properties', 'Permissions', 'Departments', 'Ticket Notifications', and 'Other Notifications', with a settings gear icon on the right. The 'Properties' tab is active. The form contains several sections: 'Name' with a text input field containing 'Newbie Agent' and a checkbox 'Display a different name to end-users'; 'Email Address' with a text input field containing 'new.agent@a1 corp.example.com'; 'Zones' with two checkboxes, 'Admin Interface' and 'Reports Interface'; 'Teams' with three checkboxes, '1st Level Support' (checked), '2nd Level Support', and 'Support Managers'; and 'Permission Groups' with three checkboxes, 'All Non-Destructive Permissions' (checked), 'All Permissions', and 'Interns'. Below the 'Permission Groups' section, there is a note: 'Switch to the **Permissions** tab to manage permission overrides.' At the bottom of the form, there are two buttons: 'Save' (blue) and 'Delete' (red).

We'll discuss these settings in more detail, but for now, use the **Properties** tab to set up your first agents' accounts.

Teams are a way of assigning tickets to groups of agents instead of a single agent. The default teams we've given you ("1st Level Support", "2nd Level Support" and "Support Managers") are just an example - you can rename or replace them later.

Agent **permissions** control what each agent is allowed to do. You can set these down to very fine details, but the quick way to set permissions is by adding agents to a **Permission Group**. While your first agents are getting used to DeskPRO, putting them in the **All Non-Destructive Permissions** group will let them use most features of DeskPRO while limiting the potential for mistakes.

Zones control which agents can access the admin interface (marked with a wrench icon) or the reports interface (marked with a bar chart icon). It's a good idea to give at least one other person admin access, in case there's a problem with the helpdesk and you're not available.

Bear in mind that anyone with admin access can delete or alter most of the data in the helpdesk, including deleting your account, so you should only grant admin access to people you trust with that power!

3.3. Set up ticket email accounts

You can now set up the email accounts where users will submit messages to be turned into tickets. Any new message to these accounts is automatically converted to a ticket within your helpdesk. If it's part of an ongoing conversation, it will be shown as a reply to a ticket.

Note that a ticket email account can't also be used as an agent/admin email address. This is necessary to prevent email loops; otherwise DeskPRO could end up replying to its own emails endlessly. It's best to add agents using personal email accounts (e.g. `john.smith@yourcompany.com` or `agent1@yourcompany.com`), rather than with generic addresses like `support@`.

While most helpdesks use email to accept tickets, it's not essential; you could choose to have users submit all tickets through the web portal.

Email account configuration differs slightly between the Cloud and Download products.

DeskPRO Cloud support email configuration

If you are using DeskPRO Cloud, you will first create cloud-hosted support email accounts with addresses ending `@yourcompany.deskpro.com`.

You can ask users to submit tickets to these addresses straight away, but you probably have an existing support address like `help@yourcompany.com`. In that case, you can use the **custom email address** option to forward email from the existing address to a cloud address - for example, you would forward `help@yourcompany.com` to `help@yourcompany.deskpro.com`.

The **New Ticket Trigger** settings affect what happens when a new ticket is created from this a custom email address. + **Department** is the department assigned automatically to the ticket. The default 'Support' department is a good choice for your first email address. + **Send user an auto-response confirming their new ticket** uses a template that you can customize under **Tickets > Email Templates**. You can also set the **From Name** that the user sees on the email.

The helpdesk will then send emails out with your custom address in the "From" field. This means your users will never see the default DeskPRO email address.

DeskPRO Download support email configuration

Here's how to add your first support email account in DeskPRO Download:

- 1 Go to **Tickets > Email Accounts** and click **New Email Account**.
- 2 This screen is displayed:

Email Address *

Enter the main email address for this account.

☐ This account has additional email addresses associated with it (aliases)

Type

Ticket Email Account

Ticket accounts are email accounts that DeskPRO will download emails from and process into tickets and replies.

Account Details *

IMAP

Host localhost

Port 110

Secure ☐ Enable secure network connection

Username

Password

IMAP Folder ☒ Read messages from the inbox
☐ Read messages from a specific folder

Read Mode ☒ Read all unread messages
 DeskPRO will read and process all unread messages in the mailbox. After processing, messages are marked as read but stay in the mailbox.
☐ Read all messages and then move
☐ Read all messages and then delete

[Test Account Settings](#)

Outgoing Email *

Send mail using PHP mail()

PHP Mail Send mail through the server `mail()` function.

[Test Account Settings](#)

New Ticket Trigger

Department: Support

☐ Send user an auto-response confirming their new ticket

3

Email Address is simply the user-facing email address you want to use for support e.g. support@yourcompany.com

4

Leave **Type** as **Ticket Email Account**

5

Select the type of email account you are using, and enter the details.

- For **IMAP** and **POP3** accounts, enter the server details requested. You can find these in the settings of your email program or mail provider. **Host** means the address of the IMAP or POP3 (incoming mail) server.
- If you use a Gmail or Google Apps account, you must ensure that **POP Download** is enabled in the **Settings** page.

POP Download:
[Learn more](#)

1. Status: **POP is enabled** for all mail that has arrived since 3:17 pm
☐ Enable POP for **all mail** (even mail that's already been downloaded)
☐ Enable POP for **mail that arrives from now on**
☐ Disable POP

2. When messages are accessed with POP keep Gmail's copy in the Inbox

3. Configure your email client (e.g. Outlook, Eudora, Netscape Mail)
[Configuration instructions](#)

Enable POP for **all mail** if you want DeskPRO to import all email messages in the account inbox as tickets. Enable POP for **mail that arrives from now on** if you just want DeskPRO to process new emails.

Click **Test Account Settings** to confirm that DeskPRO can read email from the server.

6
7

For **IMAP** and **POP3** accounts, you must specify how DeskPRO sends outgoing email. The default option sends emails directly from your DeskPRO installation using a PHP function, and is suitable for most helpdesks.

Click **Test Account Settings** to try sending an email to yourself and confirm that DeskPRO can send email.

8

The **New Ticket Trigger** settings affect what happens when a new ticket is created from this email address.

- **Department** is the department assigned automatically to the ticket. The default 'Support' department is a good choice for your first email account.

3.4. Set up departments

Departments are a way to divide up the helpdesk and control access. They have multiple effects within DeskPRO. They are generally used to reflect different sections of your enterprise: for example, you might have "Support" and "Sales" departments, or "US", "France" and "UK" departments.

At this stage of setting up the helpdesk, you should consider the following properties of departments:

- 1 Each department can have its own email account. For example, you could have emails to `jobs@yourcompany.com` create tickets in the HR department, and emails to `help@yourcompany.com` create tickets in the Support department.
- 2 User and agent permissions are based on departments; if you anticipate that you will want to let some people see certain tickets but not others, this will be handled with departments.
- 3 The fields shown when a user or an agent creates a ticket through the web can be customized depending on the department.

To create or edit ticket departments, go to **Tickets > Departments**. To make a new department, you only need to enter information in the **Properties** tab.

The screenshot shows the 'Properties' tab of a department configuration page. It has four tabs: 'Properties', 'Permissions', 'Layout', and 'Website Embed'. The 'Properties' tab is active. It contains three main sections: 1. 'Title *' with a text input field containing 'Support' and a help icon. Below it is a note: 'This is the title as it will appear throughout the agent and user interfaces.' and a checkbox 'Show a different title to end-users'. 2. 'Parent' with a dropdown menu showing 'No Parent' and a help icon. Below it is a note: 'By setting a parent department, this department becomes a child. This is just an organizational feature that helps you create department structures that are easier to use.' 3. 'New Ticket Trigger' with a 'Set Email account:' label and a dropdown menu showing 'support@a1.example.com'. Below it is a checkbox 'Send user an auto-response confirming their new ticket'. At the bottom are three buttons: 'Save' (blue), 'Reset' (grey), and 'Delete' (red).

Use the **Permissions** tab to control each agent's access to tickets in each department:

- **Full** means the agent can view and work on tickets in that department.
- **Assign** means the agent can assign tickets to the department, but nothing more (they can't view them afterwards).

If departments don't seem relevant to your needs, you don't have to use them. Delete all but one department. You can always add them again later.

3.5. Set up teams

Agent **teams** are a way to allow group ticket assignment. Assigning a ticket to a team brings it to the attention of all the members of that team: it will show up in the **My Teams' Tickets** filter in the agent interface.

This is useful because agents may not know exactly who the best person is to handle a ticket, especially if you work in a large enterprise. For example, if a technical support agent finds a ticket asking for a product demonstration, but they don't know who handles those, the agent can just assign it to the 'Sales' team.

Teams usually consist of agents who work closely together and all handle the same kind of ticket (e.g. first-line support team, sales team, engineering team). Teams are not compulsory; if they don't help with your work flow, you don't have to use them.

You can create and edit teams under **Agents > Teams**. Teams only have two properties: a name and a list of agents.

Click on a team to edit its name and select its members using the checkboxes.

Team Name	2nd Level Support
Members	☐ A-1 IT Boss ☒ A-1 Sales Exec ☒ A-1 Support Agent ☒ A-1 Support Agent B ☐ Newbie Agent

Click **Add** to create a new team, enter its name, and select members.

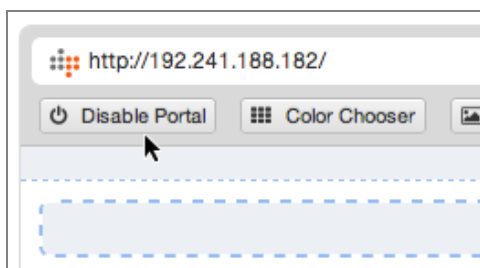
3.6. Set up the user web portal

The portal is the web-based view of the helpdesk accessible to users. They can use it to view their tickets, access useful help content created by agents with the agent interface **Publish** app, and submit feedback.

Click on the portal icon to configure it.



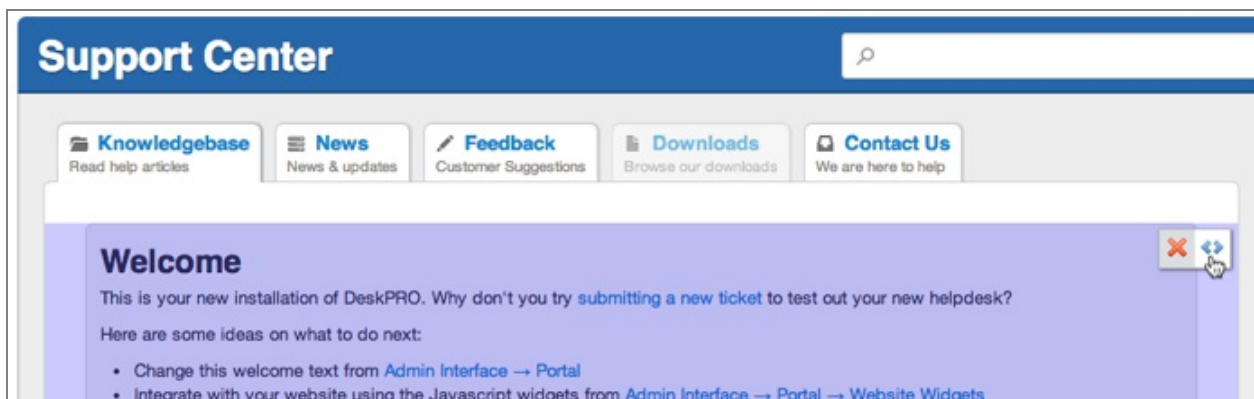
If you prefer not to use the portal, you can turn it off with the **Disable Portal** button.



With the portal disabled, users can only submit tickets via email or have them created on their behalf by agents, and can't view help content or submit feedback.

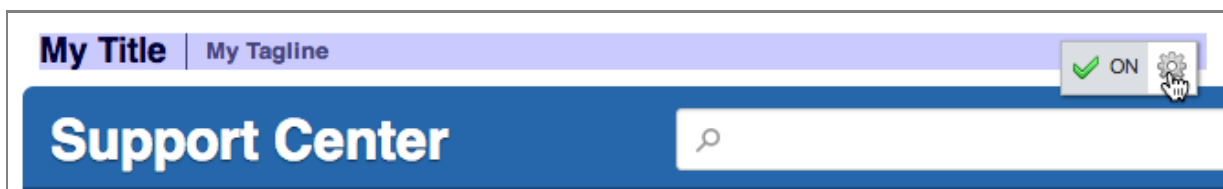
If do you want to use the portal, you should customize the default welcome message on the front page.

Mouse over the **Welcome** section of the portal, and click the edit control.



You can then edit the HTML of the welcome message to something more relevant to your users.

You might also want to customize or remove the placeholder title and tagline at the top of the portal.



There are many more ways to customize the web portal. You can add or remove sections, change the design, use a custom URL (for Cloud users), or embed it entirely within your website. See the [Customizing the User Experience](#) chapter for details.

4. Localization

We're committed to making DeskPRO suitable for international use.

There is currently support for 19 languages, with the ability to option to enter your own custom phrase translations, or to contribute new translations into languages you need.

You can also fully customize the date format.

4.1. Date & time settings

You can customize the format that DeskPRO uses to display dates and times in the **Dates and Times** section of **Settings**.

The formatting will apply to the agent interface and the user web portal.

Use the format characters from the table below to specify how DeskPRO should display dates.

For example, the date format `M j Y` means that when the interface needs to display a date, it will display something like "Jan 1 2015". If you wanted it to display "1st January 15", you would edit the Date format field to read `"jS F y"`.

format character	Description	Example output
Day		
d	Day of the month, 2 digits with leading zeros	01 to 31
D	A textual representation of a day, three letters	Mon through Sun
j	Day of the month without leading zeros	1 to 31
l (lowercase 'L')	A full textual representation of the day of the week	Sunday through Saturday
S	English ordinal suffix for the day of the month, 2 characters	st, nd, rd or th. Works well with j
z	The day of the year (starting from 0)	0 through 365
Week		
W	ISO-8601 week number of year, weeks starting on Monday	Example: 42 (the 42nd week in the year)
Month		
F	A full textual representation of a month, such as January or March	January through December
m	Numeric representation of a month, with leading zeros	01 through 12
M	A short textual representation of a month, three letters	Jan through Dec
n	Numeric representation of a month, without leading zeros	1 through 12
Year		
Y	A full numeric representation of a year, 4 digits	Examples: 1999 or 2003
y	A two digit representation of a year	Examples: 99 or 03
Time		
a	Lowercase Ante meridiem and Post meridiem	am or pm

A	Uppercase Ante meridiem and Post meridiem	AM or PM
g	12-hour format of an hour without leading zeros	1 through 12
G	24-hour format of an hour without leading zeros	0 through 23
h	12-hour format of an hour with leading zeros	01 through 12
H	24-hour format of an hour with leading zeros	00 through 23
i	Minutes with leading zeros	00 to 59
s	Seconds, with leading zeros	00 through 59
Timezone		
e	Timezone identifier	UTC, GMT, Atlantic/Azores
I (capital i)	Whether or not the date is in daylight saving time	1 if Daylight Saving Time, 0 otherwise
O	Difference to Greenwich time (GMT) in hours	+0200
P	Difference to Greenwich time (GMT) with colon between hours and minutes	+02:00
T	Timezone abbreviation	EST, MDT
Full Date/Time		
c	ISO 8601 date	2004-02-12T15:19:21+00:00
r	RFC 2822 formatted date	Thu, 21 Dec 2000 16:01:07 +0200

4.2. Languages

DeskPRO has support for many international languages, and we are using crowdsourced translation to improve our language support.

At **Setup > Languages** you can see:

- the default language of your helpdesk
- installed languages
- other installable languages

The screenshot shows the 'Default Language' section with a dropdown menu set to 'English (English)'. Below this is the 'Installed Languages' section, which lists three languages: 'English (English)' with 'admin', 'agent', and 'user' labels; 'العربية (Arabic)' with a 'user' label; and 'Français (French)' with 'agent' and 'user' labels. At the bottom is the 'Other Installable Languages' section, which lists 'Dansk (Danish)' with a 'user' label.

The level of translation support varies: most language packs currently have translations for **user** text (portal and emails) only. Some are additionally translate the **agent** interface (and agent notification emails), and some translate admin as well.

The level of support is denoted by the blue labels.

DeskPRO records a language for tickets and users. When a new ticket/user is created, the language is not defined, and DeskPRO uses the default language.

Users can pick their preferred language (from those you have installed) when they are logged in to the web portal, using the language selection control at the upper right.

The screenshot shows a 'Language:' dropdown menu with three options: 'English' (selected), 'العربية', and 'Français'. A mouse cursor is pointing at the 'Français' option.

Agents can also change the user's language from within the agent interface, using the **Properties** section of the user record.

The screenshot shows the 'PROPERTIES' section of a user record. It has 'Cancel' and 'Save' buttons. Below the buttons are two fields: 'Timezone' and 'Language'. The 'Language' field has a dropdown menu with three options: 'English', 'Français' (selected), and 'العربية'. A mouse cursor is pointing at the 'Français' option.

Changing a user's language will change the language in which they view the web portal, as well as the language of their notification emails.

When a user's language changes, all their tickets are switched to that language.

Installing a new language

Installing a supported language is easy. Just go to the **Other Installable Languages** section, click on the language you want to install, then click **Install Language**.

After you've installed the language, you can click on it to view its settings.

The screenshot shows a form for configuring a language. It includes the following sections:

- Title:** A text input field containing "English". Below it, a note says "The language title as it appears to users."
- Edit Phrases:** A blue button with a speech bubble icon and the text "Edit Phrases".
- Locale Code:** A text input field containing "en_US". Below it, a note says "This is the standard locale code for the language."
- Flag:** A dropdown menu showing a US flag and the text "us".
- Availability:** A section stating "This language pack has translations for the following areas:" followed by a bulleted list:
 - The user portal and user emails
 - The agent interface and agent email notifications
 - The admin interface and the reporting interface

At the bottom of the form is a blue "Save" button.

For a full translation, you will need to provide translations for any custom values you have entered. For example, if you enable French, DeskPRO won't know the correct French names for your teams, departments etc, so you have to enter them.

- 1 Click on your newly-installed language to view detailed settings.
- 2 Click the **Edit Phrases** button, and on the following page, click on the first entry under **Resources**.
- 3 In each **Resources** section, click on each item in the **Translated** column, and enter a translation into the new language, then click **Save**.

The screenshot shows the translation interface for the language "Français (French)". On the left, there is a sidebar with a "Resources" section containing links for "All Custom Phrases", "Ticket Departments" (which is highlighted), "Chat Departments", and "Products". The main area displays a table with two columns: "Default" and "Translated".

Default	Translated
Support	Au secours!
Sales	Prix réduit!

At the bottom of the table is a blue "Save" button.

- 4 Repeat until you have translated all your custom values.

Note that if you're not satisfied with the translation of other areas, you can change the **User Interface Phrases** from the same page. Edit the **Custom** column to override the default translation of phrases in the web interface or emails to users.

You can select which country's flag to display for each language. This is useful if the language you've installed is used in multiple countries, but you want to display the flag for a particular country.

If you don't want to install languages one by one, you can click **Settings & Tools** at the bottom of the page, then select **Automatically install new languages**.

Changing the default language

Simply select an installed language from the **Default Language** pulldown to change the default language.

The new language will be applied to all users (and agents/admins if the language pack supports it) who haven't explicitly picked a language.

From **Settings & Tools**, you can apply mass updates to tickets or users. This is useful if you want to apply the new default language to users who have not explicitly picked a language.

For example, suppose most of your users speak Russian and you have been evaluating DeskPRO for a week with only English installed, during which time some users have registered.

You would update all 'no language' users to Russian. Any users who hadn't explicitly selected English as their language would have their language set to Russian.

Agent language support

If a language has **agent** support, agents can select which language they wish to use from their **Preferences** in the agent interface.

You can't change agent language from the admin interface, except by logging in as the agent.

Helping us to expand language support

If the language you want is not available, or doesn't support all the interfaces you require, you can contribute a translation via our crowdsourced translation system at <http://languages.deskpro.com>.

Please contact us at support@deskpro.com to request access.

5. Importing User Data

If you have data on users from another system, and you want to quickly create DeskPRO accounts for them, you can import data as a CSV (*Comma-Separated Values*) file. CSV is a simple comma-separated text format that can be exported from spreadsheet programs (e.g. Excel) and databases.

The exact format of the CSV file containing user data doesn't matter. The DeskPRO import function lets you select which column from the CSV file corresponds to which field in DeskPRO.

You can also import data from certain [legacy helpdesk systems](#).

Instead of importing data, you can allow users or agents to log in using credentials from a different system (for example, from an existing database, or their network login) by installing [authentication apps](#).

If you have other data import requirements, please contact us at support@deskpro.com.

5.1. Importing user data in CSV format

Here's an example of how a simple user data CSV file might look in your spreadsheet program:

	A	B	C	D
1	Brian Coyot	coyote1@example.com	Aardvark Inc.	enter
2	Maria User	maria1961@example.com	DreadCo	rando
3	Davey	daveyh@example.com		extra
4	Sue Cheam	suey333@example.com	Alpha	junk

and in a text editor:

```
Brian Wolf,coyote1@example.com,Aardvark Inc.,enter
Maria User,maria1961@example.com,DreadCo,rando
Davey,daveyh2@example.com,,extra
Sue Cheam,suey333@example.com,Alpha,junk
```

Some programs may output CSV files with the fields quoted, e.g.:

```
"Maria User","maria1961@example.com","DreadCo","rando"
```

DeskPRO will ignore the quotation marks when importing the data.

Note that some programs may output "CSV" files where the fields are separated by semicolons ; or tabs, instead of commas. Importing these formats is not supported; consult the documentation for the software you're exporting from to find out how to output a comma-separated file.

In **CRM > CSV import**, click **Select CSV File**, select the CSV file with your data, then **Click here to upload file**.

Once the file is uploaded, you can use the next screen to map the CSV columns to DeskPRO fields.

Import CSV File

Configure Importing:

Column Name	Example Data	Mapping Field
Brian Coyot	Maria User	First Name
coyote1@example.com	maria1961@example.com	Primary Email
Aardvark Inc.	DreadCo	Organization ☒ Create if does not exist
enter	rando	Do Not Map

☐ Skip the first row
 This should be selected if the "column name" values above contain labels rather than actual data.

☒ Import the first row
 This should be selected if the "column name" values above contain actual data.

[Click here to start Import](#)

By default, the importer assumes that the first row of your data consists of labels like "Name", "Email" etc. If that is *not* the case (as in this example) you should select the **Import the first row** option.

All users must have at least one email address, so you must select a mapping to the "primary email" field.

- Users without a valid email address will not be imported.
- If an account already exists with a user's primary email address, the user will not be imported.

If you do not map a password field, a random password will be generated automatically for each user.

Once you have the configuration you want, you can start the import. The import will be automatically scheduled and done for you in the background. You do not need to keep your browser on the page except to get status updates as the import happens.

Importing into custom fields

If your data set has fields that you can't map to standard DeskPRO fields, you can import them into custom fields. If you haven't created the fields ahead of time, you can create them when configuring the import by selecting the **New Custom Field** mapping option.

If you create a new choice-based field, new choices will be automatically created as new values are found for the field. If you import into an existing choice-based custom field, you can control whether new choices will be automatically created.

To import into a date-based custom field, the data you are importing must either be a UNIX timestamp or in the format YYYY-MM-DD (for example, 2012-10-24).

Importing contact data

The CSV importer supports importing contact data such as phone numbers and addresses and assigning a "label" to them. This label can be used to indicate, for example, a business phone versus a home phone. The label is optional in most cases.

However, when importing addresses, the label field is used to group related address parts together (such as the street with the city with the postal code). Therefore, if your data set has two or more sets of addresses, you must enter a distinct label for each "set" of address fields.

For example, if your data has "Business Street", "Business City", "Home Street" and "Home City", then you would need to enter one label (e.g.) for "Business Street" and "Business City", and a different label (e.g.) for "Home Street" and "Home City".

6. Ticket Customization

You can customize the information stored in a ticket using optional built-in fields and custom fields.

Categories are a general field, often used to handle grouping tickets within a department.

Priorities describe how important a ticket is. The different priority values you set have an order, from most to least important.

Workflows are used to record the ticket's stage in your support process - for example "Triage", "Troubleshooting", "Follow-Up".

Products usually denote a real product or service that your enterprise offers and your helpdesk supports. If enabled, products can apply to items other than tickets, such as feedback and articles.

Custom fields are the most flexible way to add extra information to tickets. The four built-in fields are each designed for a particular purpose; if you need a new ticket field for some other reason, use a custom field. You decide the name of the field as well as the possible values; you can pick from a variety of formats for the allowed input (for example, a short text string, or selecting predefined choices).

For each of these fields you can set a default value. You can use **validation** rules to require users, agents or both to select a value when creating a ticket through the portal or agent interface.

Note that for these fields to be visible, they must be included in the relevant form layout under **Departments**.

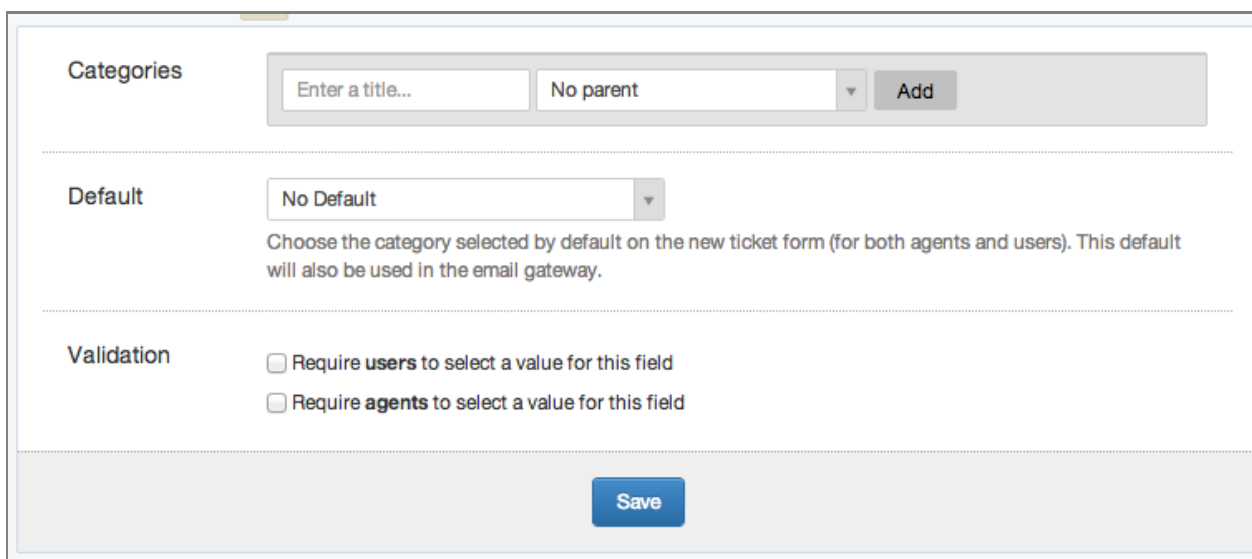
When you create a custom field, you can also select whether it is displayed to agents only, or to both users and agents.

6.1. Categories

Categories are a way to group similar tickets. Departments are used to represent different parts of your enterprise, while categories can be used to record different *types* of tickets. For example, you could use categories to classify emails as 'Questions'/'Product Defects'/'Other'; that would then enable you to compare the number of tickets about product defects between different departments.

To create categories:

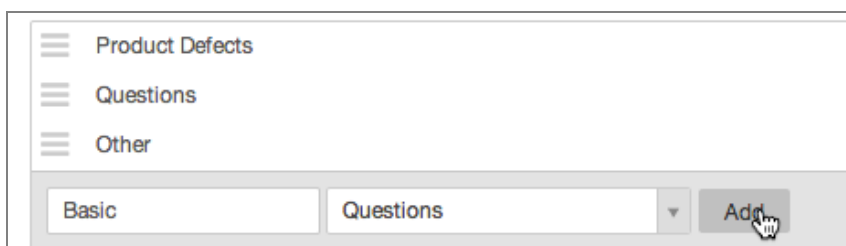
- 1 Go to **Tickets > Fields** and make sure that the **Categories** switch control is on.
- 2 Click **Categories**, fill in the name of the category you want to create in the **Enter a title...** box, and click **Add**.
- 3 Enter your desired categories, then click **Save**.



The screenshot shows the 'Categories' configuration form. It has three main sections: 'Categories', 'Default', and 'Validation'. The 'Categories' section has a text input 'Enter a title...', a dropdown menu 'No parent', and an 'Add' button. The 'Default' section has a dropdown menu 'No Default' and a description: 'Choose the category selected by default on the new ticket form (for both agents and users). This default will also be used in the email gateway.' The 'Validation' section has two checkboxes: 'Require users to select a value for this field' and 'Require agents to select a value for this field'. At the bottom is a 'Save' button.

Categories can have subcategories one layer deep. For example, you could divide the 'Questions' category into 'Basic' and 'Advanced'.

To create a 'child' category, enter a new category as normal, then change the drop-down menu to the right from **No parent** to the desired parent category. For example, this would create the subcategory 'Basic' within 'Questions':



The screenshot shows the 'Categories' configuration form with a list of existing categories: 'Product Defects', 'Questions', and 'Other'. Below the list, the 'Enter a title...' input contains 'Basic' and the dropdown menu is set to 'Questions'. The 'Add' button is highlighted with a mouse cursor.

If categories are enabled, users and agents can select a category when they create a ticket, through the portal Contact Us form or the agent interface, respectively.

Setting a **Default** category prefills that category in the user and agent forms. The user/agent can change the category; they can clear it unless validation is enabled. Tickets submitted via email will be assigned to the default category.

Under **Validation** you can require users and/or agents to select a category when they submit a ticket through the web. This does not apply to tickets submitted via email; if it is important that new tickets are assigned a category, set a default category.

6.2. Priorities

Priorities are an alternative way to record how important it is to answer a certain ticket.

Priorities differ from urgency in the following ways:

- Priorities are an ordered set of named values, e.g. 'Routine', 'Urgent', 'Critical', whereas urgency is a numerical score from 1 to 10.
- Actions from triggers, SLAs, macros and escalations cannot *increase* or *decrease* priority; they can only set a particular priority value. In contrast, you can have an action that increases urgency by 4.
- Priority can be seen and set by users, whereas urgency is only ever visible to agents.

Priorities can be useful when the service you offer has different tiers. For example, suppose you offer a service plan where you allow users to declare 'Critical' tickets, which you guarantee to answer faster than normal tickets.

You could implement this in DeskPRO by setting 'Critical' as a priority, allowing users to select it when they submit a ticket, and then defining a new SLA that is applied to new tickets with 'Critical' priority.

To create priorities:

- 1 Go to **Tickets > Fields** and make sure that the **Priorities** switch control is on.
- 2 Click **Priorities**, fill in the name of the priority you want to create in the **Enter a title...** box, and click **Add**.
- 3 Repeat until you have made all the priorities you want.
- 4 Drag priorities by the handles at left to order them, from the least important at the top to the most important at the bottom.

The screenshot shows the 'Priorities' configuration page in DeskPRO. At the top, there is a list of existing priorities: 'Routine', 'Urgent', and 'Critical', each with a handle icon on the left and a delete icon on the right. Below this list is a form to add a new priority, consisting of a text input field labeled 'Enter a title...' and an 'Add' button. Underneath the add form, there is a 'Default' section with a dropdown menu currently set to 'Routine'. A note below the dropdown states: 'Choose the category selected by default on the new ticket form (for both agents and users). This default will also be used in the email gateway.' Below the default section is a 'Validation' section with two checkboxes: 'Require users to select a value for this field' (unchecked) and 'Require agents to select a value for this field' (checked). At the bottom of the form is a blue 'Save' button.

The order of priorities is used:

- when displaying them to users/agents
- to enable agents to order tickets by ascending or descending priority in the list pane

Setting defaults and validation for priorities works just as with categories.

6.3. Workflows

Workflows are a way to record the stage of your support process that a ticket has reached.

Ticket **status** essentially records only whether an agent or user is due to reply to a ticket. By design, there is no way to add extra **statuses** in DeskPRO.

DeskPRO admins often want to be able to add extra statuses; for example, to record that a ticket is brand new and needs to be assigned to the relevant team, or that it is ready to be resolved and should be reviewed by quality control.

Workflows are a way to record this sort of information; for example, you could have workflow values of 'Triage', 'Support' and 'QC', and automatically assign 'Triage' to new tickets.

To create workflows:

- 1 Go to **Tickets > Fields** and make sure that the **Workflows** switch control is on.
- 2 Click **Workflows**, fill in the name of the workflow value you want to create in the **Enter a title...** box, and click **Add**.
- 3 Repeat until you have made all the workflow values you want.
- 4 Drag workflows by the handles at left to order them. This only affects the order of display to agents.

The screenshot shows the 'Workflows' configuration page in DeskPRO. At the top, there is a list of existing workflow categories: 'Triage', 'Support', and 'QC', each with a handle icon on the left and a delete icon on the right. Below this list is a form to add a new workflow, consisting of a text input field labeled 'Enter a title...' and an 'Add' button. A horizontal dashed line separates this from the 'Default' section, which features a dropdown menu currently set to 'Triage'. Below the dropdown is a descriptive text: 'Choose the category selected by default on the new ticket form (for both agents and users). This default will also be used in the email gateway.' Another horizontal dashed line leads to the 'Validation' section, which contains two checkboxes: 'Require users to select a value for this field' and 'Require agents to select a value for this field'. At the bottom of the form is a blue 'Save' button.

6.4. Products

Products are a way to link tickets to products or services that your helpdesk supports. For example, if your company makes software, you might use products to track different versions and platforms.

Note that, unlike the other built-in fields, products can apply to items other than tickets, such as feedback and Knowledgebase articles.

Products can have subproducts, which work the same way as nested categories.

To create products:

- 1 Go to **Tickets > Fields** and make sure that the **Products** switch control is on.
- 2 Click **Products**, fill in the name of the product you want to create in the **Enter a title...** box, and click **Add**.
- 3 Repeat until you have made all the products you want.
- 4 You can drag products by the handles at the left to order them. This only affects the order of display to users/agents.

The screenshot shows the 'Products' configuration page in DeskPRO. At the top, there is a list of products with handles on the left and delete icons on the right. The products listed are: Robo-cat, Robo-cat Mk 1, Robo-cat Mk 2, Drivers, Windows, and Mac. Below the list is a form to add a new product, with a text input field labeled 'Enter a title...', a dropdown menu currently showing 'Drivers', and an 'Add' button. Below this, there is a 'Default' section with a dropdown menu set to 'No Default' and a descriptive text: 'Choose the category selected by default on the new ticket form (for both agents and users). This default will also be used in the email gateway.' Underneath is a 'Validation' section with two checked checkboxes: 'Require users to select a value for this field' and 'Require agents to select a value for this field'. At the bottom of the form is a blue 'Save' button.

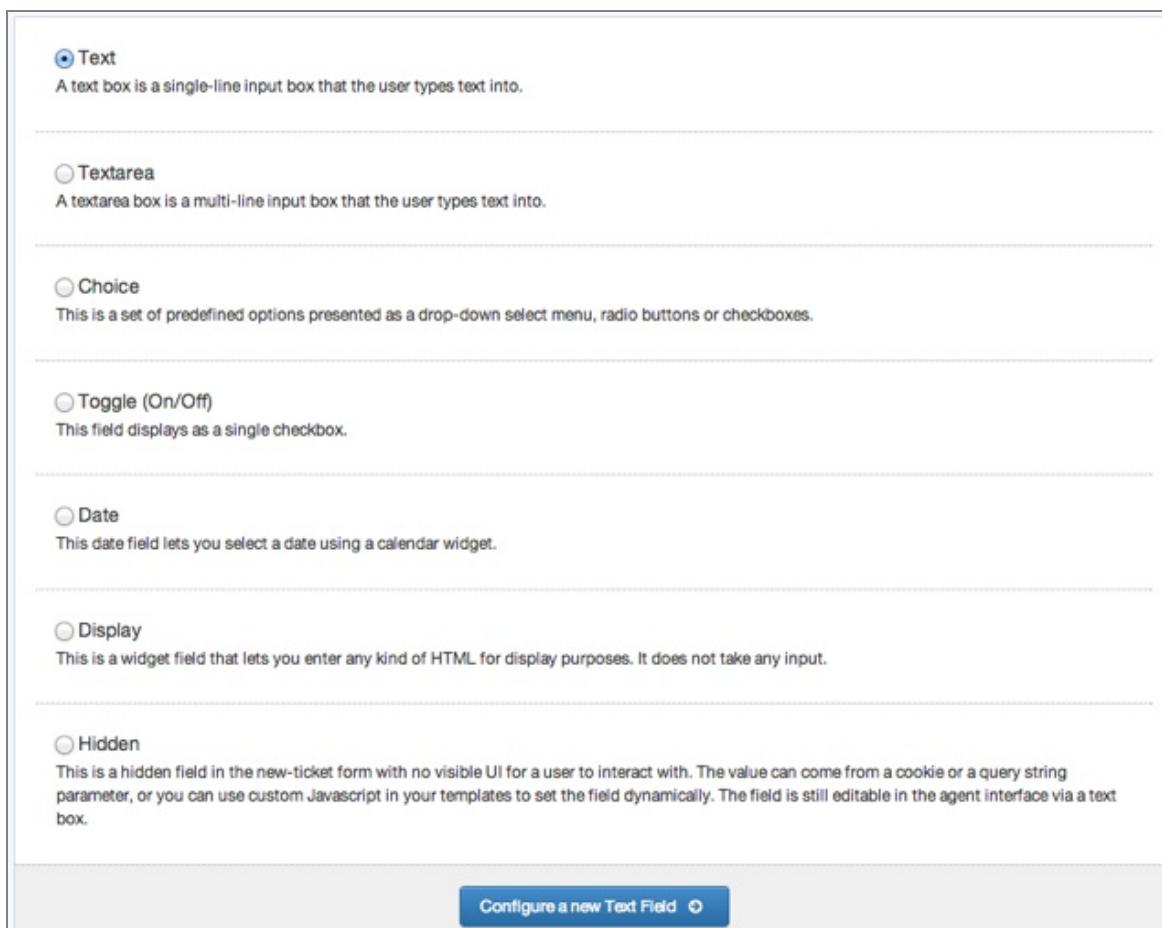
Setting defaults and validation for product works as with categories.

6.5. Custom fields

Custom ticket fields are the most flexible way to add extra information to a ticket.

You can also add custom fields to users, organizations, and chats. These are all separate systems; even if you have a custom ticket field and a custom user field with the same name, you'll need to set their properties separately.

To create a custom field, go to **Tickets > Fields**, then click the **+ Add** button in the Custom Field section.



The screenshot displays the 'Custom Field' configuration interface. It features a list of field types, each with a radio button and a description:

- Text** (selected): A text box is a single-line input box that the user types text into.
- Textarea**: A textarea box is a multi-line input box that the user types text into.
- Choice**: This is a set of predefined options presented as a drop-down select menu, radio buttons or checkboxes.
- Toggle (On/Off)**: This field displays as a single checkbox.
- Date**: This date field lets you select a date using a calendar widget.
- Display**: This is a widget field that lets you enter any kind of HTML for display purposes. It does not take any input.
- Hidden**: This is a hidden field in the new-ticket form with no visible UI for a user to interact with. The value can come from a cookie or a query string parameter, or you can use custom Javascript in your templates to set the field dynamically. The field is still editable in the agent interface via a text box.

At the bottom, there is a blue button labeled 'Configure a new Text Field' with a right-pointing arrow.

There are a number of options for what sort of data a custom field stores:

- Text - 136 characters
- Textarea - large amount of text
- Choice: Select box Multiple-select box Radio buttons Checkboxes
- Toggle - on or off
- Date
- Display
- Hidden - visible only to agents, takes information from portal/website

When you create a custom field, you must then add it to the form layout under **Tickets > Departments** for it be visible to users/agents.

6.6. Time log & billing

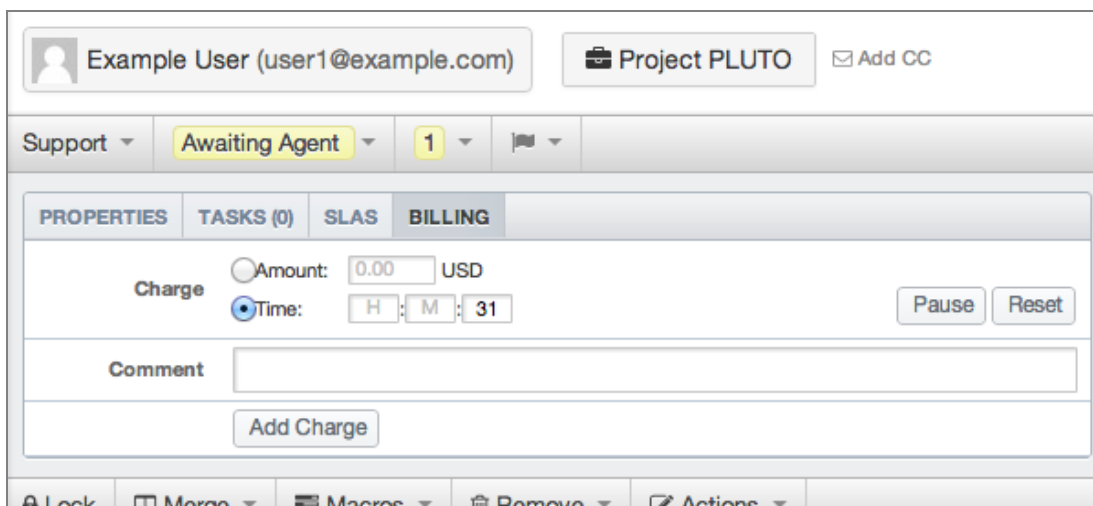
If your agents need to bill users based on the support they provide, you can enable the **time log** and **ticket billing** features.

The time log lets agents record the amount of time they spend on a ticket, while ticket billing lets them specify an amount of money to charge for support.

This is not to be confused with the **Billing & Licensing interface** where you pay for your DeskPRO

license, accessible through the  icon at the lower left.

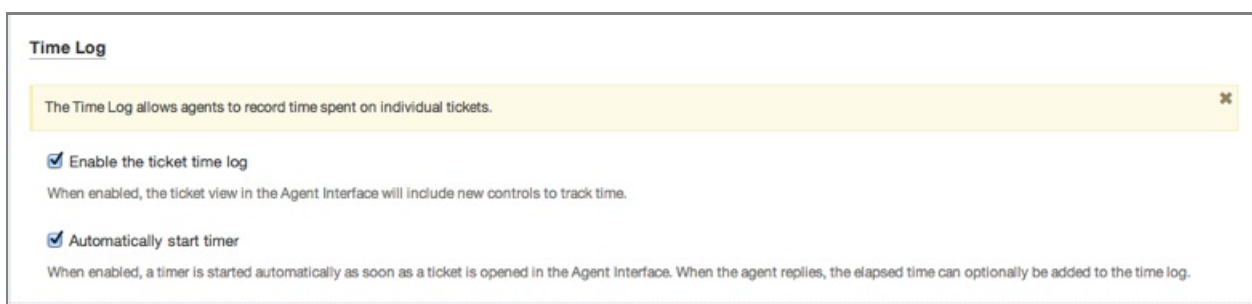
You can enable time logging and billing separately. If either option is enabled, tickets in the agent interface have a **Billing** tab.



The screenshot shows the DeskPRO agent interface. At the top, there's a header with a user profile (Example User, user1@example.com), a project name (Project PLUTO), and an 'Add CC' button. Below this is a navigation bar with 'Support', 'Awaiting Agent', and a count of '1'. The main content area has tabs for 'PROPERTIES', 'TASKS (0)', 'SLAS', and 'BILLING'. The 'BILLING' tab is active, showing a 'Charge' section with radio buttons for 'Amount' (0.00 USD) and 'Time' (H: M: 31). There are 'Pause' and 'Reset' buttons. Below this is a 'Comment' text area and an 'Add Charge' button. At the bottom, there's a toolbar with 'Lock', 'Merge', 'Macros', 'Remove', and 'Actions'.

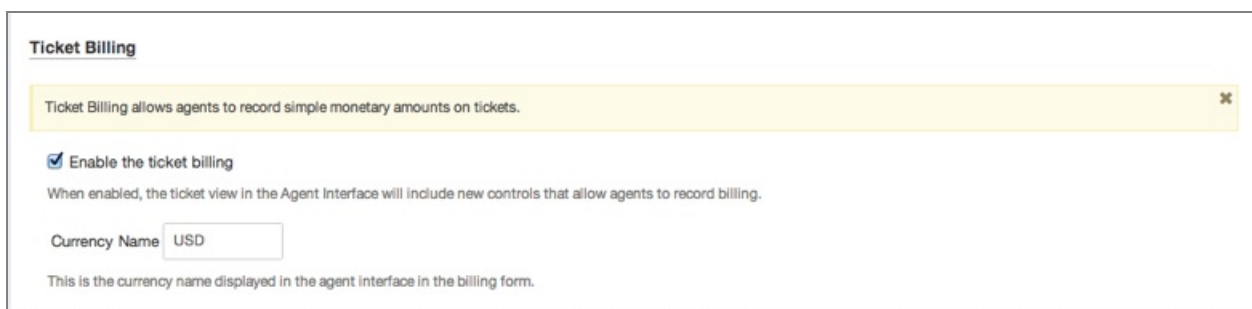
Go to **Tickets > Time Log & Billing** to change the settings.

The **Time Log** sections lets you enable the time log, and choose whether to **Automatically start timer** as soon as the ticket is opened by an agent. Note that the agent still has to press the **Add Charge** button to save the elapsed time.



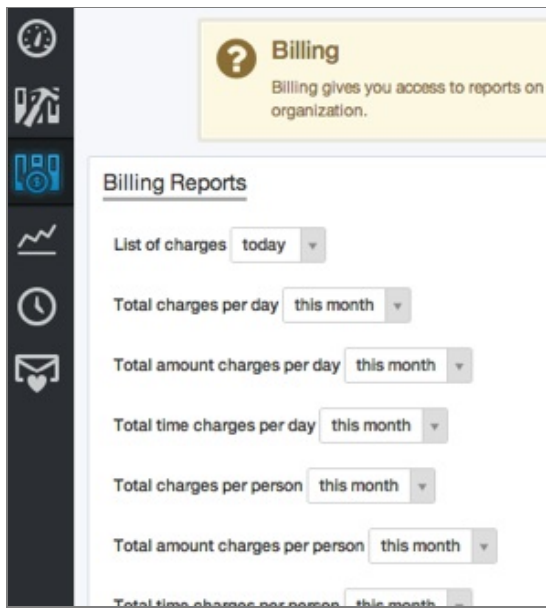
The screenshot shows the 'Time Log' settings page. It has a title 'Time Log' and a description: 'The Time Log allows agents to record time spent on individual tickets.' There are two checkboxes: 'Enable the ticket time log' (checked) and 'Automatically start timer' (checked). Below each checkbox is a brief explanation of what happens when it's enabled.

The **Ticket Billing** section lets you enable or disable monetary billing. You can edit the currency name.



The screenshot shows the 'Ticket Billing' settings page. It has a title 'Ticket Billing' and a description: 'Ticket Billing allows agents to record simple monetary amounts on tickets.' There is a checkbox 'Enable the ticket billing' (checked). Below it is a text input field for 'Currency Name' with 'USD' entered. A note at the bottom says: 'This is the currency name displayed in the agent interface in the billing form.'

Users are not notified of times and charges recorded by agents - you will need to bill users outside of DeskPRO. To facilitate this process, you can use the **Reports** interface to see summaries of all charges; note that you can generate reports by organization as well as by user.



Billing

Billing gives you access to reports on organization.

Billing Reports

List of charges

Total charges per day

Total amount charges per day

Total time charges per day

Total charges per person

Total amount charges per person

Total time charges per person

7. Departments

Departments are used to divide up the helpdesk into separate areas.

Every ticket always has a department.

The department field has a number of different effects:

- Agent permissions are based upon departments; you can configure it so that agents can view tickets/chats in some departments, but not others.
- User permissions are based upon departments; you can configure it so members of a usergroup can create tickets/chats in some departments, but not others.
- Different departments can have different custom form layouts.
- You can have embedded contact forms which only allow users to submit tickets to a particular department.
- You can set a user-facing department name to be displayed only to users e.g. agents see "Terms of Service Violations", while users see "Support".
- You can link email accounts to departments (e.g. have tickets submitted via `sales@yourdomain.com` assigned to the "Sales" department, tickets submitted via `help@yourdomain.com` assigned to the "Support" department, etc.).

As well as ticket departments, there are **chat departments**. The two types of department are not linked; you configure departments separately for tickets and chats.

Departments usually reflect different divisions of your enterprise with different requirements. Here are some common scenarios where you would need to use departments:

- You want to have separate contact forms for sales requests and support requests, with different custom fields.
- You want to configure your helpdesk so that your manufacturing staff only see manufacturing tickets, and your retail staff only see retail tickets, while your research staff can see everything.
- You want any user to be able to chat with your sales department, but only users in the "Premium" usergroup are allowed to use your technical support chat.

You can have an unlimited number of departments. Most enterprises will have fewer than ten departments, but you can structure your departments as you feel suitable.

A department can have sub-departments, e.g. the "Support" department can contain "Support Tier 1" and "Support Tier 2". Note that you can't assign tickets to a department if it contains sub-departments; you must assign to the sub-departments. In the example above, you could assign tickets to "Support Tier 1" and "Support Tier 2", but not to the parent-level "Support".

7.1. Configuring departments

To manage your ticket departments, go to **Tickets > Departments**.

At left, you'll see the list of departments currently in your helpdesk. The defaults for a new helpdesk are "Support" and "Sales", but you are free to edit these.

You can change the order of departments by dragging them with the handles at left. This just affects the order in which they're displayed to users and agents.

To edit a department, click its name.

If you decide you don't want to use departments at all, just delete all but one of them. Tickets always have a department, but if you only have one department defined (without more than one sub-department), it will not be shown to users, effectively disabling the field.

Department properties

The screenshot shows the 'Properties' tab of a department configuration form. It includes fields for 'Title' (set to 'Support'), 'Parent' (set to 'No Parent'), and 'New Ticket Trigger' (set to 'Set Email account: a1.help.address@gmail.com'). There are checkboxes for 'Show a different title to end-users' and 'Send user an auto-response confirming their new ticket'. At the bottom are 'Save', 'Reset', and 'Delete' buttons.

Properties | Permissions | Layout | Website Embed

Title * 

This is the title as it will appear throughout the agent and user interfaces.

☐ Show a different title to end-users

Parent

By setting a parent department, this department becomes a child. This is just an organizational feature that helps you create department structures that are easier to use.

New Ticket Trigger Set Email account:

☐ Send user an auto-response confirming their new ticket

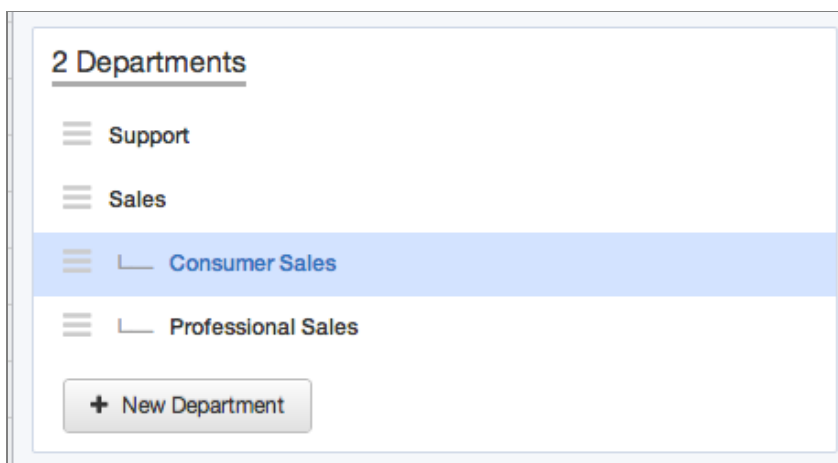
Edit the **Title** field to change the department's name. Click the globe icon to enter translations for each language you have enabled.

You can choose to **Show a different title to end-users** if you want to enter an alternative name for the department to be displayed to users in the web portal.

To create a sub-department, create a new department and then select its **Parent**. For example, you could create a **Consumer Sales** department, then make its parent **Sales**.

Note that if a department is a *parent* (i.e. has sub-departments), you can only assign tickets to its sub-departments. If you make a department with its own tickets into a parent, its tickets are moved to the sub-category.

As a result, there is little point having only a single sub-department within a department - in the example above, you would want to create a **Professional Sales** sub-department as well.



You can only have sub-departments one layer deep: i.e. you can have **Sales > Consumer Sales** and **Sales > Professional Sales** sub-departments, but not **Sales > Consumer Sales > Budget Range**

7.2. Department permissions

Click the **Permissions** tab for a ticket or chat department to edit the related permissions.

Ticket department permissions: users

In the **User Group Permissions** section of a department's **Permissions** tab, you can select which [usergroups](#) have permission to create tickets in that department.

User Group Permissions

User Group permissions control which of your end-users can select a department when submitting or editing their tickets from the web portal.

Note that it is still possible for agents to change the department to one that a user would not normally have access to. Triggers can also be used to assign any department regardless of user permissions. User group permissions are therefore very much about what the user can select themselves.

User Group	Use
 Everyone	☐
 Registered	☒
 VIP	☒

Note that this permission setting only affects *creating* tickets. If a ticket is assigned to the user, they will be able to see it on the portal, get replies etc, regardless of department permissions; and similarly, if the user is CC'd into the ticket, they will receive ticket messages.

If the user only has permission to select one department, the department field is not shown at all on contact forms etc.

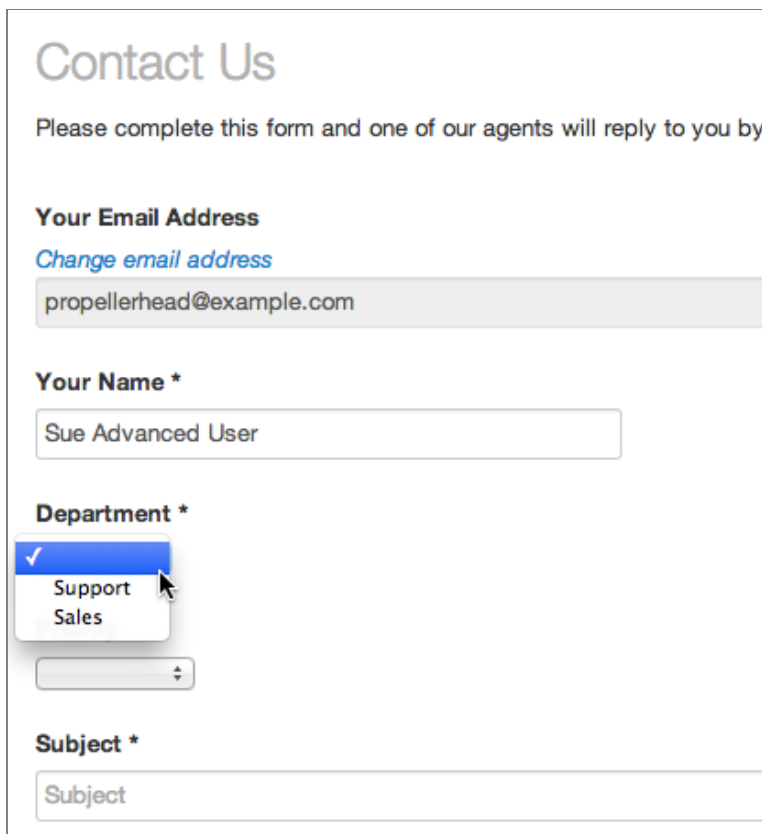
For example, suppose you have two departments, "Support" and "Sales".

You set the permissions for the groups like this:

User Group		Use
 Everyone	Sales	☒
 Registered		☒

User Group		Use
 Everyone	Support	☐
 Registered		☒

On your portal contact form, a user who is logged in will see this:



Contact Us

Please complete this form and one of our agents will reply to you by

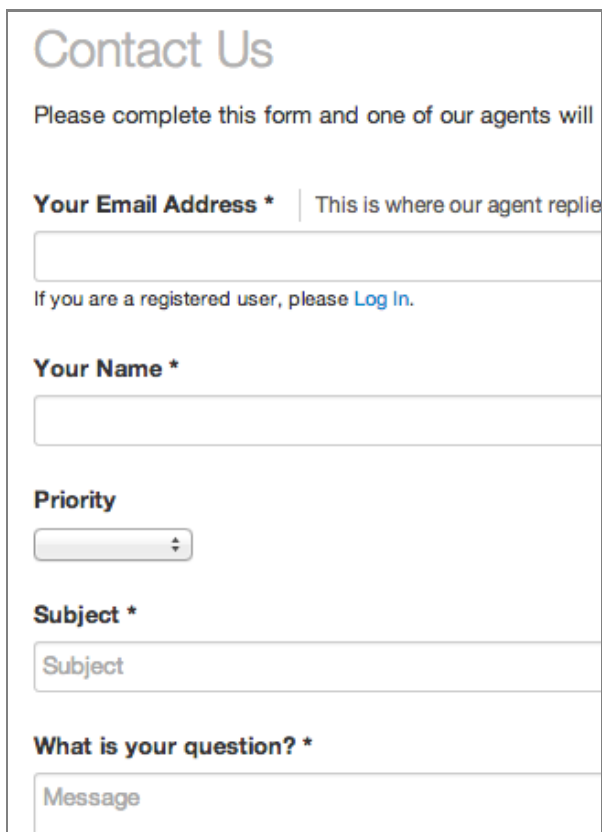
Your Email Address
[Change email address](#)
propellerhead@example.com

Your Name *
Sue Advanced User

Department *
Support
Sales

Subject *
Subject

whereas a user who isn't logged in will see this:



Contact Us

Please complete this form and one of our agents will

Your Email Address * | This is where our agent replies

If you are a registered user, please [Log In](#).

Your Name *

Priority
Priority

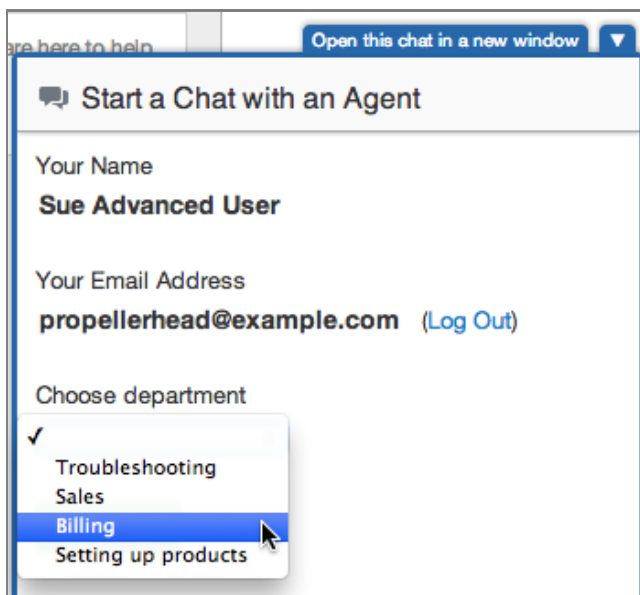
Subject *
Subject

What is your question? *
Message

The user registration settings under **CRM > Registration** can override department permissions; for example, if the **Everyone** usergroup has permission to create tickets in a department, but registration is required, guest users who aren't logged in will not see the contact form at all.

Chat department permissions: users

Chat department permissions for users work as for ticket departments, except that they control which departments users can select when they initiate a chat.



Ticket department permissions: agents

In the **Agent Permissions** section of a department's **Permissions** tab, you can select which [agent permission groups](#) and individual agents have access to that department.

Agent / Agent Group	Assign	Full Access
All Non-Destructive Permissions	☒	☒
All Permissions	☒	☒
Interns	☐	☐
Sales	☒	☐
Tech support	☒	☒
A-1 IT Boss	☒	☒
A-1 Sales Exec	☒	☒

There are two levels of agent permission for departments:

- 1 **assign** means that the agent can assign tickets to the department
- 2 **full access** permission means the agent can view and work with tickets in the department as normal

This means that an agent who only has **assign** permission can assign a ticket to a department, but will not be able to view it afterwards.

Note that department permissions are overridden by ticket assignment and following. If a ticket is assigned to an agent or one of the agent's teams, or the agent is added as a follower, the agent can view and work with it regardless of department.

You can also manage these settings from **Agents > Agent Permission Groups**

In the screenshot above, you will see that many of the permissions are on and locked. There are two reasons for this:

- 1 granting **full access** includes **assign**, so if the agent/group has been granted **full access**, **assign** is locked on.
- 2 if an agent is a member of a user permission group which already grants them a permission, it will be locked on.

Chat department permissions: agents

Chat department permissions for agents work like those for ticket departments, except they control which chats agents can accept. Unlike the two permission levels of **assign/full access** for ticket departments, chat department access is either on or off.

7.3. Ticket form layouts

You can configure the fields which appear in the forms used to submit and edit tickets:

- For users, the Contact Us form in the web portal, and any embedded ticket forms.
- For agents, the ticket form in the agent interface.

You can have different forms depending on the ticket department. Default values and data validation are properties of the field, not the form, but you can have different validation rules for users and agents.

To edit a form layout, go to **Tickets > Departments** and click on the **Layout** tab.

By default, all your forms use the same default layout. The buttons at the top of the **Layout** tab enable you to switch between editing the default, or just editing the form for the current department.

The screenshot shows the 'Layout' tab for configuring ticket forms. At the top, there are two buttons: 'Use Default Form Layout' and 'Use Custom Form Layout for "Support"'. A callout box points to these buttons with the text: 'Select whether to edit all departments or just this one'. Below these buttons is a blue banner with the text: 'All of your departments are using the default layout. You can make changes to this layout, and they will be applied to all departments too.' A callout box points to this banner with the text: 'Select whether to edit the user or agent form using tabs'. Below the banner are two tabs: 'User Form' and 'Agent Form'. A callout box points to these tabs with the text: 'Select whether to edit the user or agent form using tabs'. The main area displays a list of fields currently in the form, each with a menu icon on the left and a settings icon on the right. A callout box points to this list with the text: 'Fields currently in the form'. To the right of the field list is a panel titled 'Ticket Fields · Manage Fields' and 'User Fields · Manage Fields'. The 'Ticket Fields' panel contains a button 'User confirms T&Cs'. The 'User Fields' panel contains buttons for 'Name', 'Timezone', 'Language', and 'Level'. A callout box points to these panels with the text: 'Unused fields'. Below the 'Ticket Fields' panel is a button 'Remove field from form'. A callout box points to this button with the text: 'Remove field from form'. Below the 'User Fields' panel is a button 'Edit field details'. A callout box points to this button with the text: 'Edit field details'. At the bottom of the field list, there is a field labeled 'Attachments' with a callout box pointing to it with the text: 'Custom field'. At the bottom of the field list, there is a field labeled 'User confirms T&Cs'.

On the left is the list of fields currently in the form; the blue tabs at right are fields which are available for adding to the form (including custom fields for both tickets and users).

Drag and drop the blue fields you want onto the form. You can also set the order by dragging the fields on the form up and down.

Note that you can add both **ticket** fields and **user** fields. This enables you to have the user submit their identifying data, such as their account number, from the ticket form - see our Knowledgebase article [Adding custom user fields to ticket forms](#) for details.

For all but the compulsory fields, you can click the small gear icon to set the details of how the field should behave:

The options for a field are:

- **Show this field during ticket creation**
- **Let the user view this field after the ticket is created**
 - **Only show when there is a value**
- **Let the user edit this field after the ticket is created**
- **Only show this field based on custom criteria**

So you can, for example, have users set a priority for a ticket when they initially submit it, which they can't then change. Or have a field that users can see but only agents can edit, etc.

Only show this field based on custom criteria lets you show a field selectively if it matches **all** or **any** of your specified:

- Department
- Product
- Category
- Priority
- Workflow

For example, suppose your company's "Robo-cat" hardware products have a unique serial number which is useful for debugging, but your other products don't. You want to have the user form ask for a serial number for Robo-cat products only, and only for tickets to the Support department (since users submitting Sales tickets don't have the product yet).

The screenshot shows a configuration window for a field. At the top, there is a green toggle switch labeled "Only show this field based on custom criteria". Below this, the text "Show when" is followed by a dropdown menu set to "all", and then "of the following criteria match:". There are two criteria listed:

- Product is [Robo-cat Mk 1, Robo-cat Mk 2]
- Department is [Support]

Each criterion has a small "x" icon to its right. At the bottom of the criteria list is a green button with a plus icon and the text "Criteria".

8. Customizing the User Experience

DeskPRO offers flexible options to tailor how you present your helpdesk to users. Almost every user-facing element of the helpdesk is highly customizable, from the design of the portal to the phrasing of automatic emails.

In addition, you can integrate the portal within your existing website by embedding the following:

- The **Feedback & Support** tab widget enables users to interact with the helpdesk from an overlay without leaving your site
- The chat widget offers access to DeskPRO real-time chat from your website
- You can embed a contact form to submit a ticket on any web page.
- You can embed the entire portal within another site

8.1. Customizing email messages

Go to **Tickets > Email Templates** to customize the automatic notification emails from the helpdesk. You can change the content of both the user and agent emails, as well as making changes to the email layout which apply to both types of emails.

Email templates are configured using the TWIG template system. See <http://twig.sensiolabs.org/documentation> for more details.

Removing links to the portal

By default, if you have the DeskPRO Portal enabled, email notifications will be sent that include links to allow the user to view the ticket in the portal.

To remove those links from email notifications:

- 1 Go to: **Admin -> Tickets -> Email Notification Templates**
- 2 Select the **User Emails** tab.
- 3 Open the "New Ticket Confirmation" template.
- 4 Delete the code:

```
{{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_access_ticket_online') }}  
<a href="{{ ticket.link }}">{{ ticket.link }}</a>
```
- 5 Click **Save Template**.
- 6 Repeat the above steps for "New Ticket Created by Agent", "New Agent Reply" and "User Reply Auto-Response".

8.2. Portal design

You can customize the look of the portal to make it match the design of your enterprise's website and other user-facing materials.

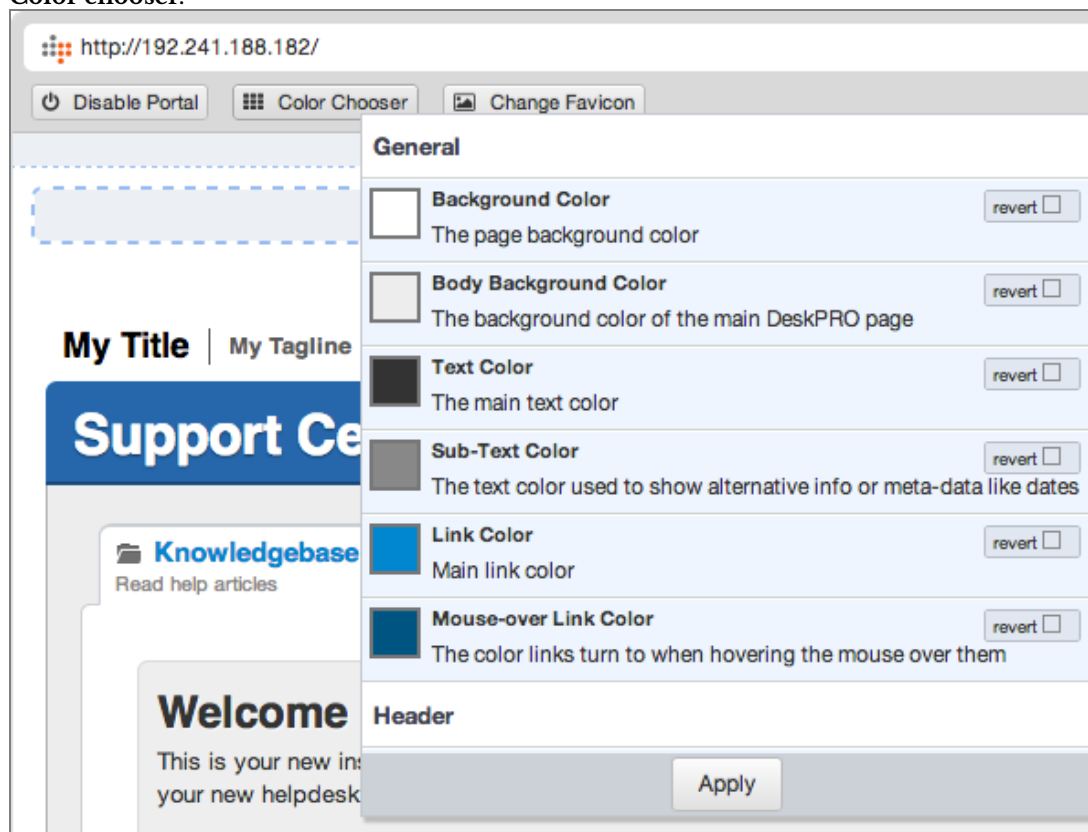
Note that in this chapter we will discuss the options that change the portal design, rather than the content. See the section on [Customizing portal content](#) to see how to change portal content.

Changing portal design with the portal editor

The easiest way to change the portal design is through **Portal > Portal Editor**.

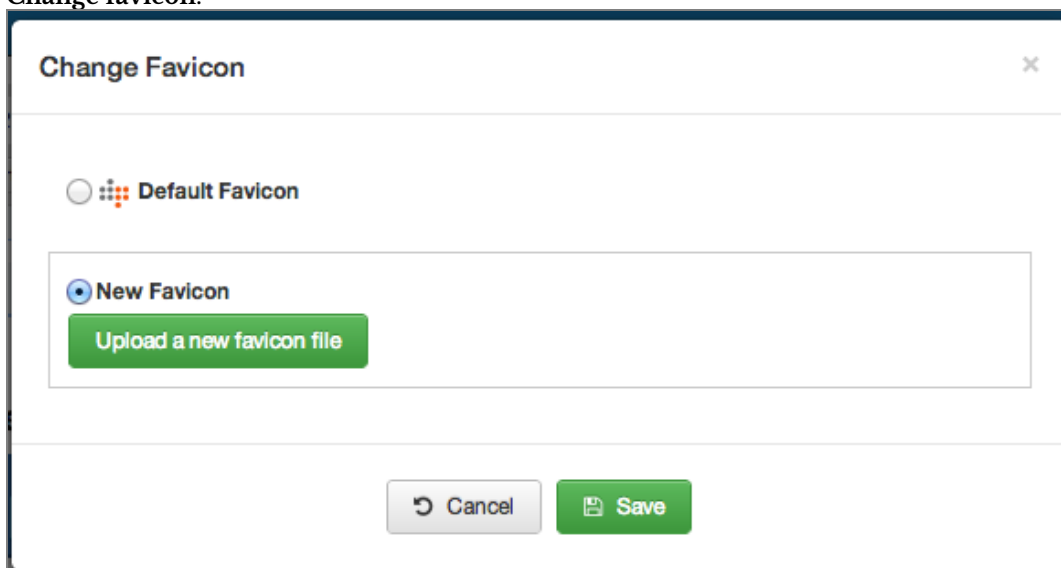
The design options available through the editor are:

Color chooser:

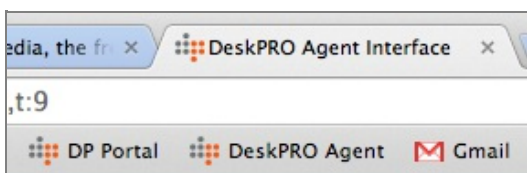


You can pick custom colors for most of the elements of the portal.

Change favicon:

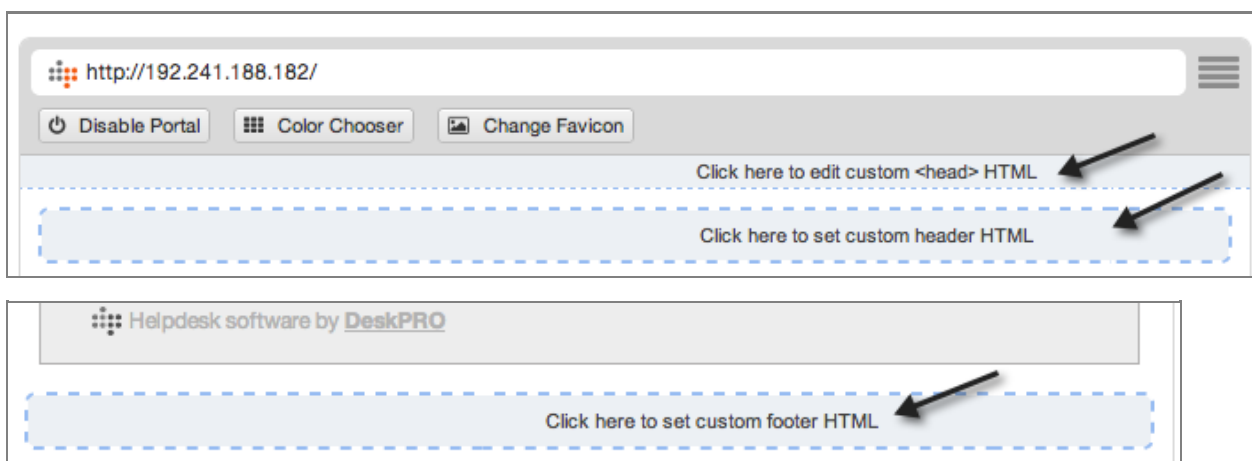


The favicon is the icon displayed by browsers to denote your site when the user bookmarks it, opens it in a tab, etc. This option lets you replace the default DeskPRO icon with your own logo.

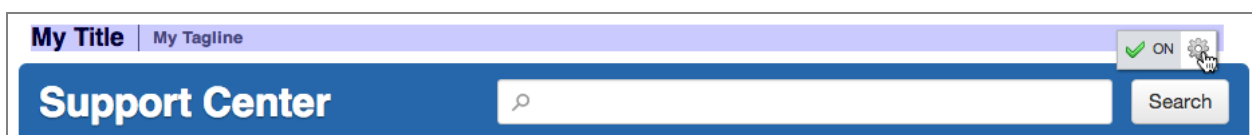


Add custom HTML: You can insert a custom header and footer which will be displayed on all the pages of the web interface. You need to enter this as HTML code.

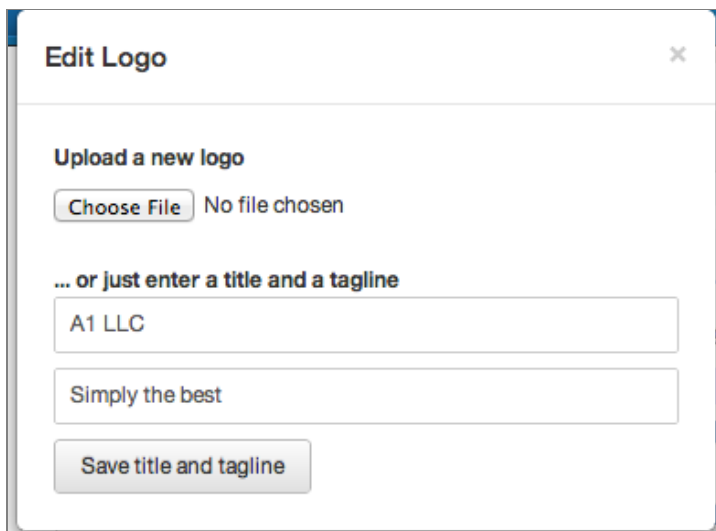
You can also enter code that will be inserted into the `<head>` element of the portal's HTML: this allows you to insert CSS or Javascript into the portal.



Add logo:



You can add a custom logo to the portal. Mouse over the title area and click the gear icon, then click **Choose file** to upload a logo image.



Edit Logo [X]

Upload a new logo

No file chosen

... or just enter a title and a tagline

Note that uploading a logo replaces any title and tagline you have entered.

Changing portal design with templates

If you need more control over the design of the portal, you can edit the HTML and CSS directly using **Portal > Templates**. With some patience and design skills, you can fully integrate the portal to look like part of your website.

Portal templates are based on the TWIG template system. See <http://twig.sensiolabs.org/documentation> for more details.

8.3. Customizing portal content

Most of the content displayed on the portal (Knowledgebase articles, news posts, downloads, and glossary terms) is created and managed from the **Publish** app in the agent interface. Feedback is managed from the agent **Feedback** app.

There are some aspects of portal content that can be customized from the admin interface.

Rearranging portal content

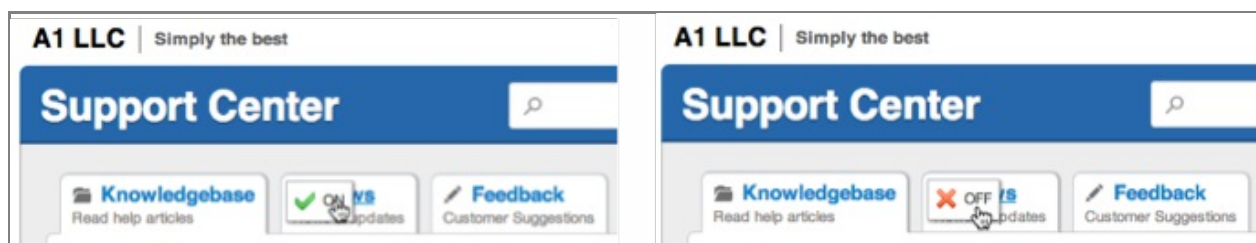
You can move most of the portal sections around.

Mouse over a section until a four-way arrow cursor is displayed. Click and hold down the mouse button while you drag the section to the desired location.

Hiding and displaying portal sections

If you don't want to use a certain portal content type, such as news posts, you can disable the relevant section of the portal from **Portal > Portal Editor**. This avoids users seeing an empty area of the portal.

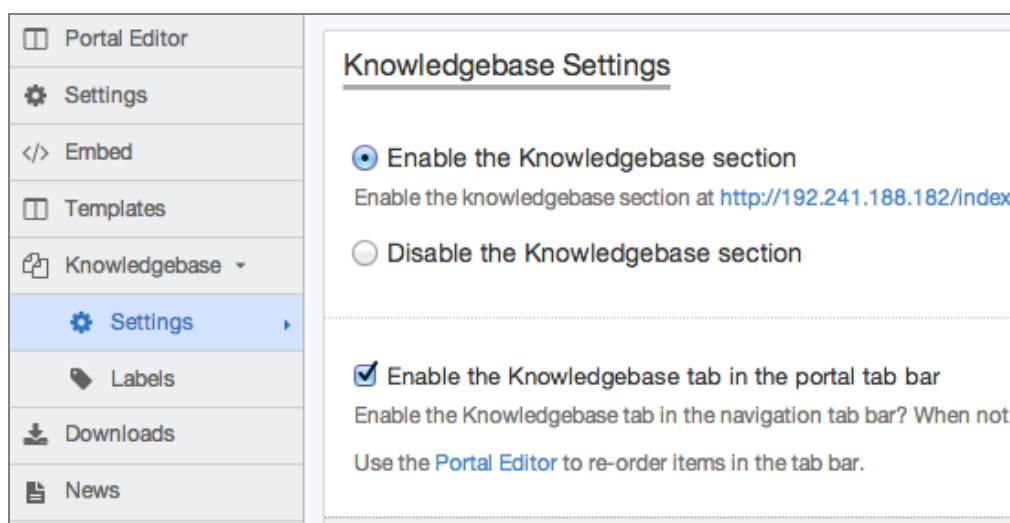
Mouse over a portal section, then click the **ON** control, to toggle the section off.



You can also drag the section tabs to reorder them.

Note that turning off a section in this way only prevents it from being displayed on the portal; any content isn't deleted, and remains accessible through the **Publish/Feedback** in the agent interface. You can continue to create content even if the section isn't being displayed. So you could, for example, disable your Knowledgebase section while it's empty, write an initial set of articles, then enable it again.

In the individual settings for each portal section, you also have the option to disable display of the tab, while leaving the section active. This means the section is still available for users who know the correct web address, but users who come to the portal homepage won't be able to navigate to it.



For example, suppose you have drivers in your Downloads section that should only be installed on the advice of an agent. You could disable the Downloads tab, so users can't find the section and experiment with drivers, but you could still easily send links to the drivers when needed.

Permissions will also affect the display of portal sections.

Sections are not shown if the user does not have:

- the correct *usergroup* permissions (set in **CRM > Permission Groups**)
- for Contact Us, sufficient *department* permissions to use at least one department available on the form (set in **Tickets > Departments** in the **Permissions** tab)

Note that the **Everyone** and **Registered** usergroups can affect what agents see on the portal. For example, suppose you have a single department, with **Everyone** and **Registered** permissions disabled. Your agents will not be able to see the **Contact Us** section on the portal, even if they have *agent* permissions to use that department in the agent interface.

User Group Permissions ?

User Group	Use
 Everyone	☐
 Registered	☐
 Troublemakers	☒
 VIPs	☒

Agent Permissions ?

Agent / Agent Group	Assign	Full Access
 All Non-Destructive Permissions	☒	☒
 All Permissions	☒	☒

Ticket deflection

Ticket deflection is a way to direct users to knowledgebase articles that might answer their question before they submit a ticket.

If you enable this option from **Tickets > Settings**, when users start typing into the **Contact Us** ticket submission form on the portal, matching articles will be suggested automatically.

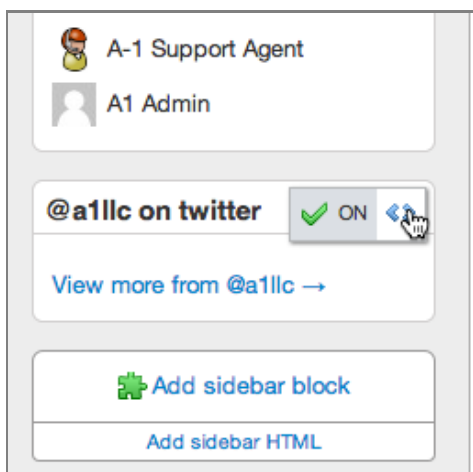
Portal contact form layout

You can edit the layout of the contact (ticket submission) form, including having different layouts for each department. See the section [Contact form layouts](#) for details.

Showing your Twitter account on the portal

You can show recent tweets from a Twitter account you control in the portal sidebar with the Twitter block.

Mouse over the block and then click on the <> control to configure it.



Enter the Twitter account you wish to include, and how many recent tweets you want to show.

You must authenticate with Twitter by clicking the link and authorizing the portal to access the account.

Custom portal sidebars

You can add custom sidebar blocks to the portal.

If you want to include a simple HTML block that is the same for all users, click **Add sidebar block** and enter the block title, and then its contents (marked up as HTML).

The **Add sidebar HTML** option is more powerful, because it allows you to use the conditional logic from the template system.

The following variables are useful for creating blocks:

{{ app.user.id }}	User ID - useful for conditional tests to see if user is logged in
{{ app.user.name }}	User's name
{{ app.user.primary_email_address }}	User email address
{{ app.user.organization.name }}	

Here's an example sidebar using conditionals to display a personalized greeting to the user, if they are logged in:

```
{% if app.user.id %}

<p>Hello, {{ app.user.name }}!</p>

<p>A1 Corp especially values the custom of your employer, {{ app.user.organization.name }}.</p>

{% endif %}
```

Custom ticket form

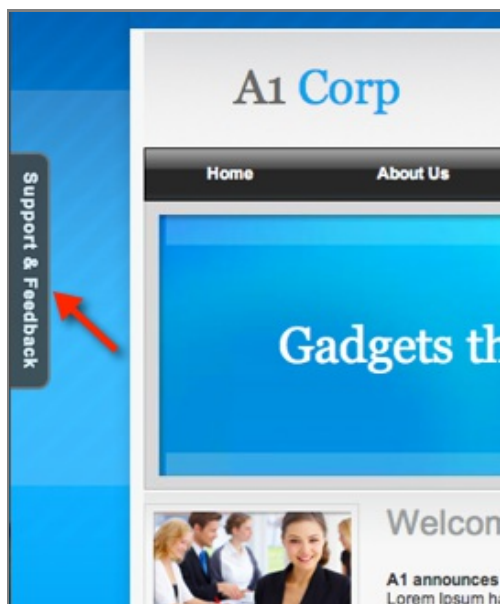
You can customize the layout of the Contact Us section ticket submission form from **Tickets > Departments**, using the **Layout** tab. See the section on [Ticket form layouts](#) for details.

8.4. Website integration

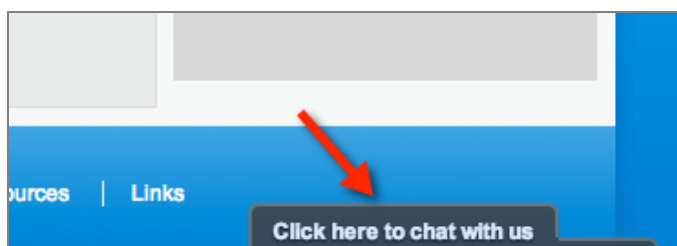
You can embed some DeskPRO functions, or your entire portal, into your existing website. This means that users don't have to navigate to your portal before using the helpdesk.

The available options for embedding are:

- a **Feedback & Support** tab at the left or right hand side of your site, giving users access to ticket submission, feedback, chat and the ability to search knowledgebase articles and news posts



- a **chat widget** at the bottom of your site

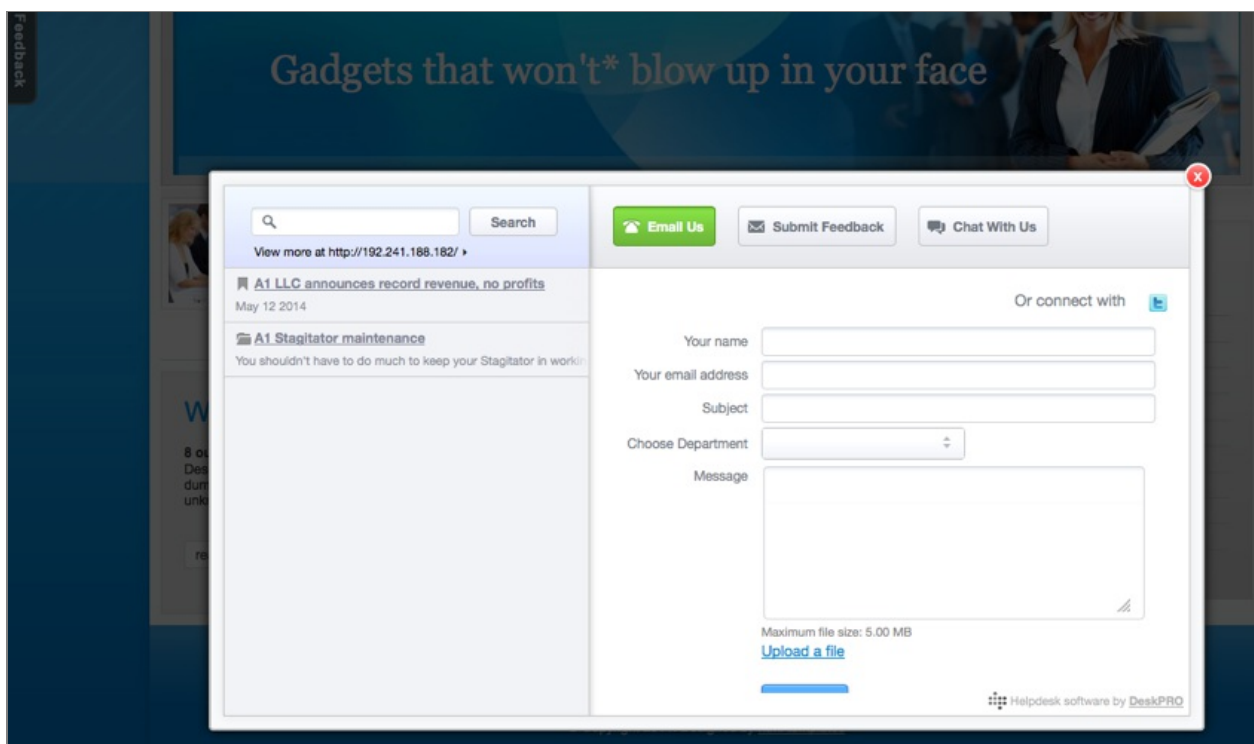


- a **contact form** for ticket submission, which can be set to submit to a particular department or allow the user to choose
- **embedding the whole portal** into a page on your site

Embedding any of these requires adding some Javascript code (which you can copy from the admin interface) to your website. It's simple, as long as you know how to edit the code of your website directly. Some "easy website builder" hosting services may not allow you to add the required code.

Embedding the Feedback & Support tab

When clicked, the Feedback & Support shows the following pop-up window over your website content:



The **Email Us** option displays a ticket submission form using your default layout from **Tickets > Departments**.

The **Submit Feedback** option enables the user to submit a feedback item, and the **Chat With Us** option enables the user to start a chat.

The search bar at the left searches through knowledgebase articles and news posts. You can also choose some articles or news items to display by default (see below).

To embed the Feedback & Support tab:

Feedback and Support Tab

The tab widget places a tab button on the left of your website. When the user clicks the tab

Tab title:

Tab position:

Language:

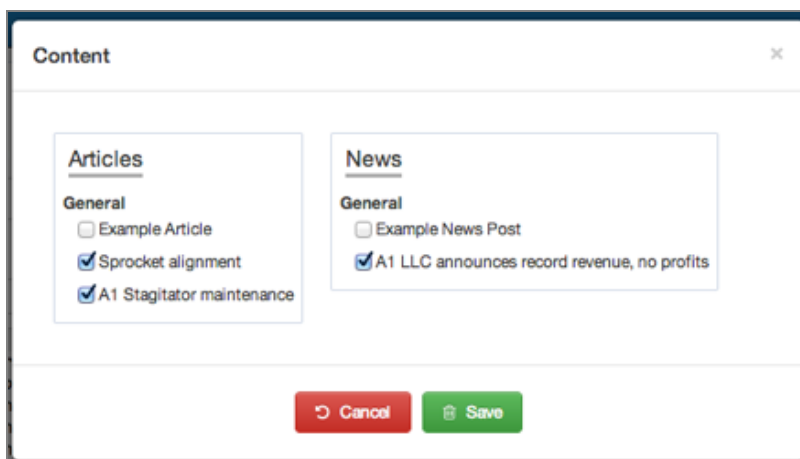
```

<!-- DeskPRO Widget -->
<script type="text/javascript">
  var DpOverlayWidget_Options = DpOverlayWidget_Options || {};
  DpOverlayWidget_Options.phrase = 'Support & Feedback';
  DpOverlayWidget_Options.tabLocation = 'left';
  DpOverlayWidget_Options.languageId = 0;
  DpOverlayWidget_Options.topPosition = '200px';
  
```

- 1 Go to **Portal > Embed**
- 2 In the **Feedback and Support Tab** section, set the options you want for your tab:
 - Edit the **Tab title** to change the text displayed on the tab.
 - Choose the **Tab position** (left or right edge of your site).
 - Set the **Language** displayed in the tab (note that unlike on the portal, the language cannot be changed by users).
- 3 Copy all the code in the text box.
- 4 Insert the code into the HTML of the page on your website where you want the tab to appear. We recommend putting it just before the `</body>` tag, i.e. after all the other page content.

Note that the settings for the above tab options are stored in the embed code. If you want to change them, you will need to copy and paste the Javascript again.

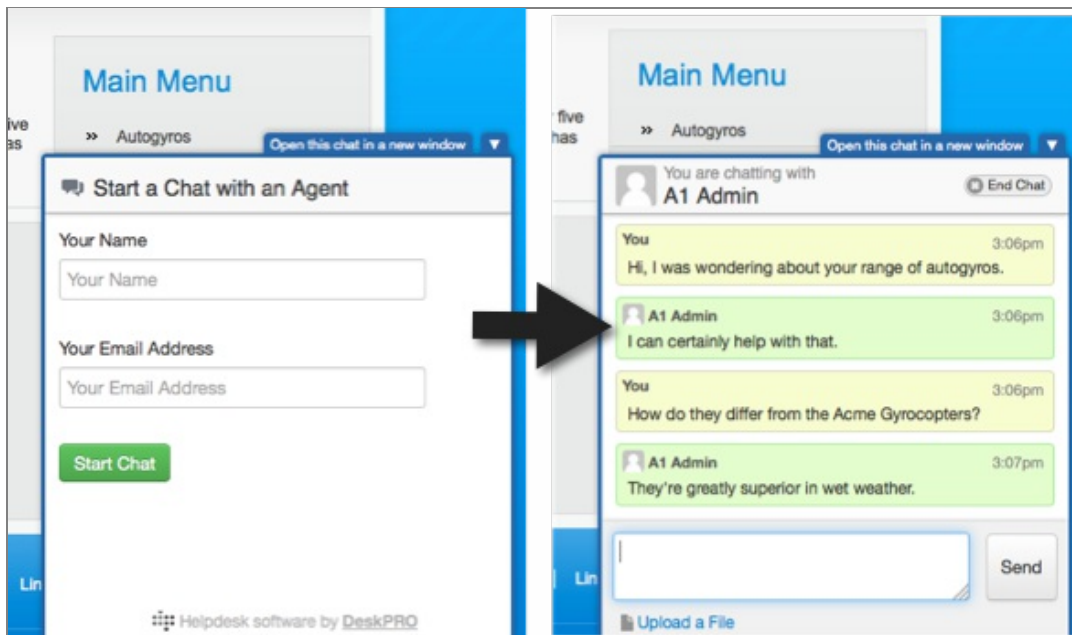
You can select the articles and news posts to display by default on the left of the overlay. Click the **Select content to show** button:



You can change this setting and the content displayed will update without you needing to re-paste the Javascript.

Embedding the chat widget

When clicked, the chat widget expands into a chat window.



Note that, depending on the chat permissions settings for the **Everyone** usergroup, users may have to log in before starting a chat.

To embed the chat widget:

Chat

The chat widget puts a small button on the bottom left of your website. When the user clicks the button, a chat to browse around your site while the chat is active.

Tab title:

Tab position:

Language:

☐ Show button even when chat is offline

```
<!-- DeskPRO Chat -->
<script type="text/javascript">
  var DpChatWidget_Options = DpChatWidget_Options || {};
  DpChatWidget_Options.startPhrase = 'Click here to chat with us';
  DpChatWidget_Options.tabLocation = 'right';

  DpChatWidget_Options.openInWindowPhrase = 'Open this chat in a new window';
```

- 1 Go to **Portal > Embed**
- 2 In the **Chat** section, set the options you want for the widget:
 - Edit the **Tab title** (text displayed on the minimized chat tab)
 - Choose the **Tab position** (bottom left or bottom right)
 - Choose the chat language.
- 3 By default, the chat widget is not shown if chat is disabled or there are no agents logged in. Check **Show button even when chat is offline** to change this; you can provide alternative text and a link where the tab will direct users when chat is offline (by default, this is to your contact form).
- 4 Copy all the code in the text box.
- 5 Insert the code on the page on your website where you want the chat widget to appear. We recommend putting it just before the `</body>` tag.

Using a custom button with the chat widget

If you want to use your own custom HTML element/button to launch the chat widget on a page, add the special classname `dp-chat-trigger` to it. For example:

```
<button class="dp-chat-trigger">Start chatting</button>
```

You can use custom CSS on your page to hide the default button, and make sure your button is hidden when agents are offline:

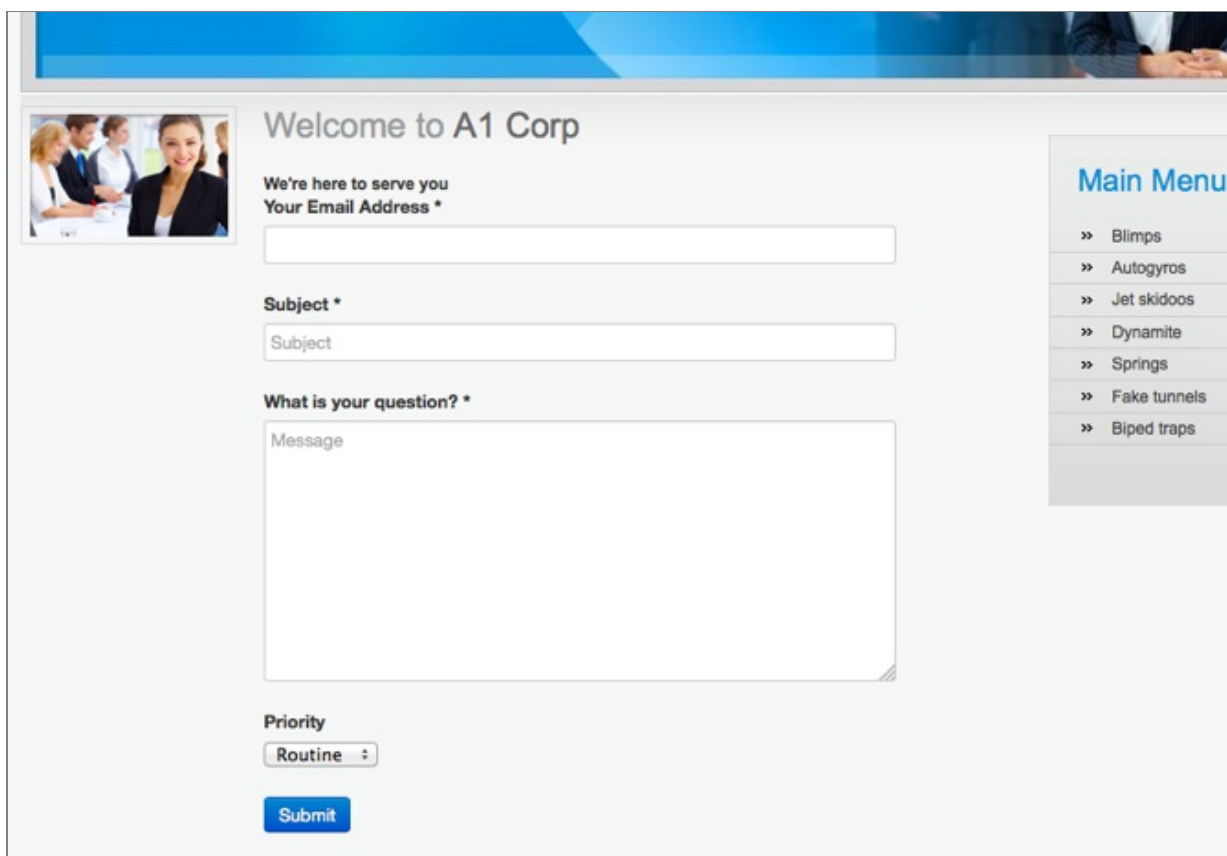
```
<style type="text/css">
#dpchat_wrap {
    display: none !important;
    visibility: hidden !important;
}

.dp-chat-trigger {
    display: none !important;
}

.dp-chat-enabled .dp-chat-trigger {
    display: block !important;
}
</style>
```

Embedding a contact form

You can embed a contact form to allow users to submit tickets from your website.



Welcome to A1 Corp

We're here to serve you
Your Email Address *

Subject *

What is your question? *

Message

Priority
Routine

Submit

Main Menu

- » Blimps
- » Autogyros
- » Jet skidoos
- » Dynamite
- » Springs
- » Fake tunnels
- » Biped traps

To embed a form:

Contact Form

Embed a contact form directly in to any web page.

Language: Default

Department: Let the user choose

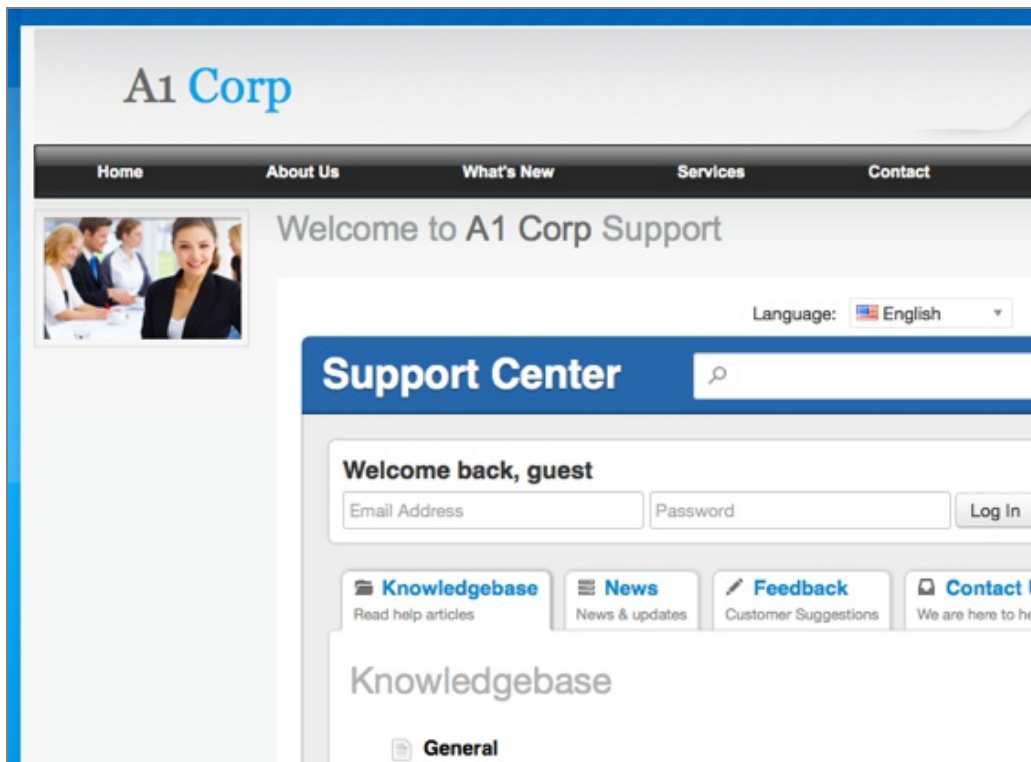
```
<!-- DeskPRO Ticket Form -->
<div id="dp_newticket_form" style="display: none;"></div>
<script type="text/javascript">
var DpNewTicket_Options = DpNewTicket_Options || {};
DpNewTicket_Options.departmentId = 0;
DpNewTicket_Options.languageId = 0;
```

- 1 Go to **Portal > Embed**
- 2 In the **Contact Form** section, select the language for the form.
- 3 Choose whether to let the user select a department, or to make this form submit to a specific department only.
- 4 Copy all the code in the text box.
- 5 Insert the code where you want the form to appear.

You can use the ability to specify a department to put the most relevant forms on each area of your site. For example, you could put a form for your Sales department on a page about an upcoming product.

Embedding the whole portal

You can embed the whole portal within a page on your website.



- 1 Go to **Portal > Embed**
- 2 Under **Embed your entire helpdesk**, set the embedding options.
 - **Hide the sidebar and border**(on by default)
 - Select which helpdesk section is displayed initially.
 - Select the initial language to display
- 3 Copy all the code in the text box.
- 4 Insert the code where you want the portal to appear.

To make the embedded portal look more like a part of your site, you could use the Portal Editor **color chooser** or edit the portal template.

8.5. Ticket ref codes

By default, a ticket's ID number is displayed to users in email notifications and the portal, and acts as the user's reference for that ticket.

The screenshot shows the 'Support Center' interface. On the left, a navigation pane includes 'Knowledgebase' and 'News'. The main content area shows a ticket titled 'Missing piece' with a 'Ticket Ref: 31' and a date 'Wed, 14th May 2014 9:35a'. Below this is a table with 'Assigned Agent' and 'Unassigned' columns, and a 'Department' row showing 'Support'. On the right, a 'Ticket' summary table lists details: ID 68, Status 'Awaiting Agent', Agent 'Acme Support Agent 1', Department 'Support Dept.', and Category 'Consumer'. Arrows highlight the ref code '31' and the ID '68'.

However, ticket ID numbers are assigned in sequence. That means they will reveal the total number of tickets you have had to your helpdesk, and let repeat users work out how many tickets you deal with. In addition, once you have a lot of tickets in your helpdesk, you will end up with long ID numbers that aren't readable or user-friendly.

You can choose to show **ref codes** to users instead of the ticket ID. A ref code is a string of numbers and letters that uniquely identifies a ticket, but isn't assigned sequentially, avoiding the problems mentioned above.

You can customize the ref code format to include information about the time the ticket was created; ticket reference `2014-01-26-AB379` is more meaningful than ticket ID `74983`.

To enable ref codes, go to **Tickets > Settings** and then the **Ticket Ref Codes** section, and check **Use ref codes**.

The 'Ticket Ref Codes' settings page features a yellow informational box stating: 'Each ticket is given a unique ID number. You may also enable "ref codes" to show a reference string to users instead of the ID number. These ref codes are generally more readable and user-friendly. By default, ref codes are in the format "ABCD-1234-EFGH". You can customize the ref code format.' Below this, the 'Use ref codes' checkbox is checked, with a note: 'Show user the ref code instead of numeric ID's in email notifications, the web portal and URLs.' The 'Use a custom ref code' checkbox is unchecked, with a note: 'Enable to use a custom format for your ref codes.'

By default, ref codes are in the format `ABCD-1234-EFGH`.

If you check **Use a custom ref code** you can enter the format you want as a string of tokens, surrounded by angle brackets. For example, `<YEAR>-<MONTH>-<A><A><A><#><#>` would give you codes such as `2014-05-QZD45`.

Anything you enter that isn't in angle brackets will be the same in every code.

Here are the available tokens:

Token	Result
<A>	A random letter

<#>	A random number
<?>	A random letter or number
<YEAR>	Year as a four-digit number (e.g. 2013)
<MONTH>	Month as a two-digit number (01-12)
<DAY>	Day as a two-digit number (01-31)
<HOUR>	Hour in 24-hour time (00-24)
<MIN>	Minute as a two-digit number (00-59)
<SEC>	Second as a two-digit number (00-59)

You can also choose to have up to 8 digits added onto the end of the code. These are added sequentially.

Ticket Ref Codes

Each ticket is given a unique ID number. You may also enable "ref codes" instead of numeric ID's. These ref codes are generally more readable and user-friendly. By default, ref codes are in the format "ABCD-1234-EFGH". You can customize the format and the number of digits added to the end of the code.

☒ Use ref codes

Show users the ref code instead of numeric ID's in email notifications

☒ Use a custom ref code ?

Enable to use a custom format for your ref codes.

<YEAR>-<A><A><?><?><?>

and append 3 digits

0 digits
1 digit
2 digits
3 digits
4 digits
5 digits
6 digits
7 digits
8 digits

Here are some examples:

<YEAR>-<MONTH> and append 3 digits	2013-10-001, 2013-10-002 (counting upwards)
<?><?><?><?><?><?>	1045885, 6947325
<YEAR>-<A><A><?><?><?><?>	2013-AB34, 2013-HXR8
ACME-<A><A><?><?><?><?><?><?>	ACME-AB2952, ACME-FV4541

9. Permissions and Access

Permissions control what actions agents and users are allowed to carry out within DeskPRO.

DeskPRO has a powerful permissions system for agents; you can shut off access to whole apps, or choose what actions to allow at a very detailed level. This enables you to give agents access only to the functions they need, simplifying training and limiting the potential damage from mistakes as agents learn to use the helpdesk.

For example, you can create a very limited account for a trainee agent that can't change or see any tickets apart from those they are specifically assigned.

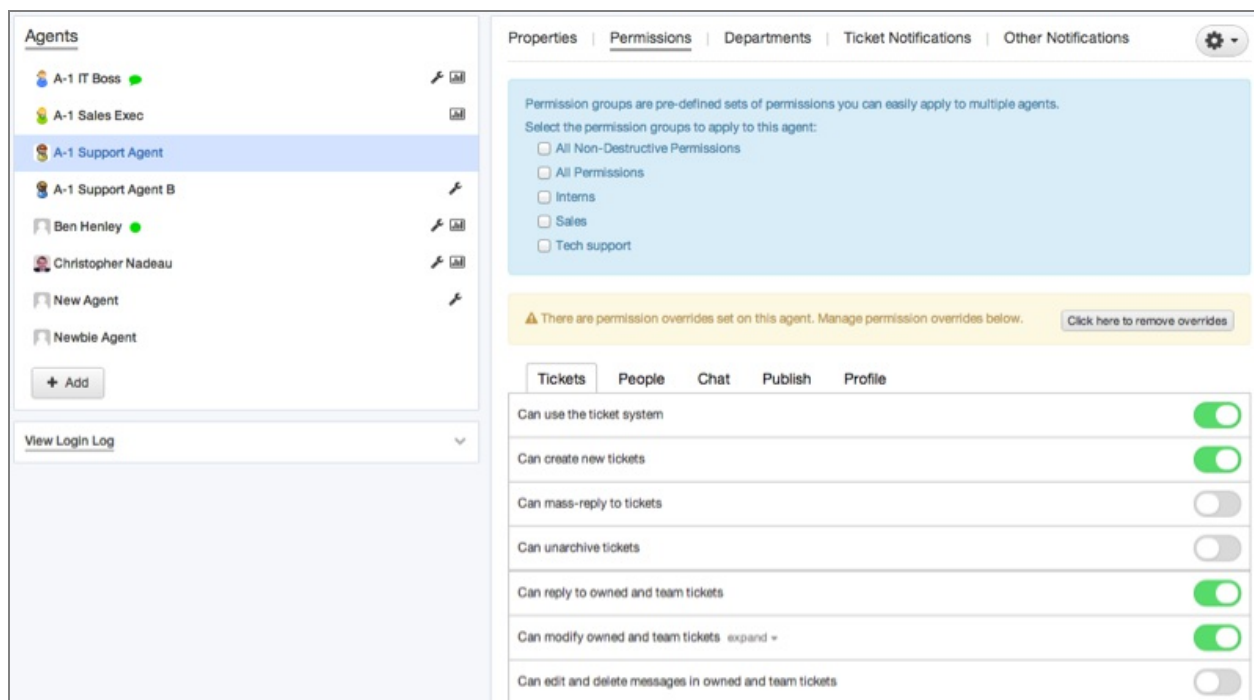
There are dozens of possible settings for each agent. To avoid the need to set each one individually for all of your agents, DeskPRO has **permission groups**, pre-defined sets of permissions you can easily apply to multiple agents.

There is a similar permissions system to control what users can do, with **usergroups** that work in a similar way to agent permission groups.

You can also set a user **registration** policy which determines how users create an account on your helpdesk, and what they can do without registering. You can configure the helpdesk so that can authenticate with credentials from outside DeskPRO, for example from a separate database, your network or using a social media account.

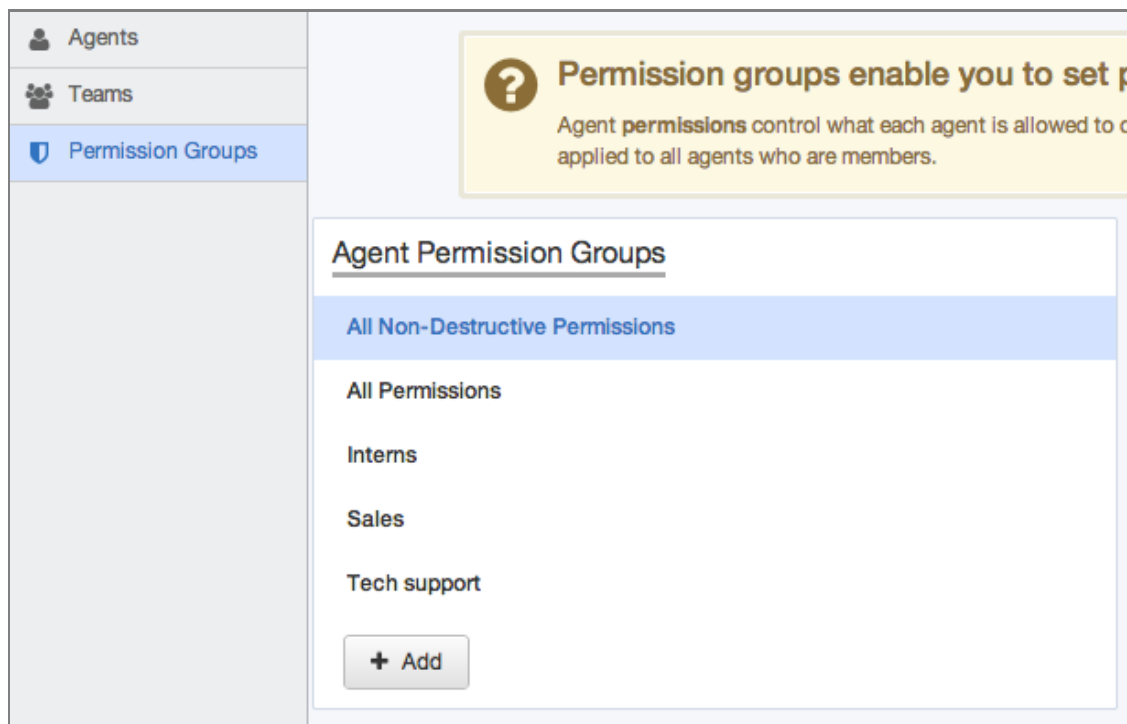
9.1. Agent permissions

To set individual permissions for an agent, go to **Agents** and click on the agent's name, then the **Permissions** tab.



You can use the toggle controls at right to enable and disable the agent's ability to carry out a wide variety of ticket actions. Click the **People**, **Chat**, **Publish** or **Profile** tabs to set permissions for other parts of the helpdesk.

Instead of making decisions about each of the dozens of possible actions for every one of your agents, we recommend you use permission groups to store sets of permissions you can quickly apply to multiple agents. These are managed from **Agents > Permission Groups**



The default groups when you first create your helpdesk are "All Permissions" and "All Non-Destructive Permissions". The latter allows the agent to use most DeskPRO features, except ones which could cause you to lose information or otherwise be harmful (like sending mass replies).

To create a new permission group, click the **Add** button.

In the **Properties** tab, enter a **Group Name**. Then click on the **Permissions** tab and set permissions as for an individual agent. You can also set [department permissions](#) for the group.

Agents can belong to more than one permission group. If an action is allowed by *any* of an agent's groups, the agent can do it.

You can either select permission groups for an agent from their **Properties** tab:

Permission Groups

- ☒ All Non-Destructive Permissions
- ☐ All Permissions
- ☐ Interns
- ☒ Sales
- ☒ Tech support

Switch to the **Permissions** tab to manage permission overrides.

Save

or add agents to a permission group from the group's **Properties**:

Properties | Permissions | Departments

Group Name: All Non-Destructive Permissions

Members

- ☒ A-1 IT Boss
- ☒ A-1 Sales Exec
- ☐ A-1 Support Agent
- ☒ A-1 Support Agent B
- ☐ New Agent
- ☐ Newbie Agent

Save

Permission overrides

You can combine individual permission settings and permission groups.

For example, this agent is a member of "All Non-Destructive Permissions".

Properties | Permissions | Departments | Ticket Notifications | Other Notifications

Permission groups are pre-defined sets of permissions you can easily apply to multiple agents.
Select the permission groups to apply to this agent:

☒ All Non-Destructive Permissions
☐ All Permissions
☐ Interns
☐ Sales
☐ Tech support

Tickets | People | Chat | Publish | Profile

Can use the ticket system	
Can create new tickets	
Can mass-reply to tickets	
Can unarchive tickets	
Can reply to owned and team tickets	

Suppose you need to grant the agent permission to mass-reply to tickets.

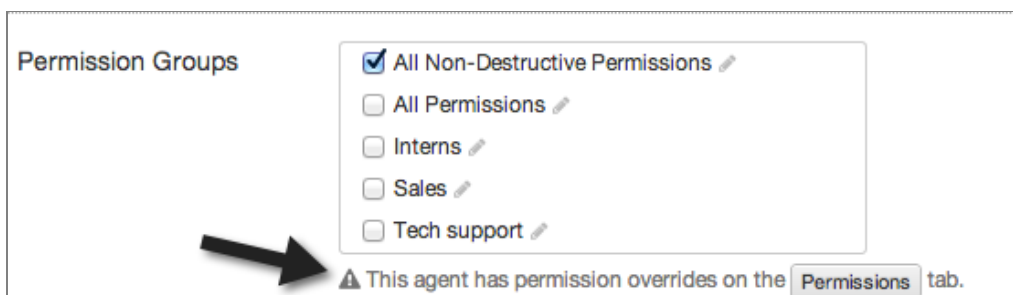
You can just click the **Can mass-reply to tickets** toggle to add that permission.

There are permission overrides set on this agent. Manage permission overrides below. [Click here to remove overrides](#)

Tickets | People | Chat | Publish | Profile

Can use the ticket system	
Can create new tickets	
Can mass-reply to tickets	
Can unarchive tickets	
Can reply to owned and team tickets	

A permission that's not granted through a permission group is considered an **override**. To make it easier to work out which agents have which permissions, DeskPRO alerts you if there are overrides, both in the agent's **Permissions** tab as you can see above, and in the agent **Properties** tab:



Note that you can't *remove* permissions which are granted by a permission group; this is indicated by the lock symbols on the other toggle controls.

Agent permissions are always additive - an agent only needs to be granted a permission by a single group or an override to be able to use it, even if none of their other groups include that permission.

Agent zones

In the **Properties** tab, you can also select what **zones** the agent can use.

Granting **admin** zone access means the agent is an admin and can use the admin interface. Note that there is no way to customize admin permissions; admin access is all or nothing.

For security reasons, DeskPRO Download admins can't reset their passwords from the web interface.

To reset an admin's password, use the command line to go to the folder where you installed DeskPRO, then run the following tool:

```
cmd.php dp:agents --reset-password
```

Granting **report** zone access enables the agent to use the Reports interface to view statistics and charts about your helpdesk's tickets, agents' performance, billing, etc.

Agent permissions for tickets and chats are also limited by departments: see the section on [Department Permissions](#) for details.

Admin access log

Admins have the power to lock out or delete other users, and make major changes to your helpdesk data that can't be undone.

You can view a log of all admin interactions with the helpdesk under **Agents > Audit Log**. This can be useful if you are trying to investigate an unexpected change to your helpdesk, or if you suspect that an admin account has been abused.

Agents	140	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	ts_agent_group:	UPDATE usergroups#1	2014-05-12 17:14:50
Teams	139	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	ts_agent_group: 1	UPDATE usergroups#1	2014-05-12 17:12:00
Permission Groups	138	Christopher Nadeau <chris.nadeau@deskpro.com>	permissions: REMOVE: Full for people#2 -- A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	UPDATE departments#2	2014-05-12 16:44:35
Audit Log	137	Christopher Nadeau <chris.nadeau@deskpro.com>	permissions: ADD: Full for usergroups#1 -- Everyone	UPDATE departments#1	2014-05-12 16:43:07
	136		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 16:42:36	UPDATE people#1	2014-05-12 16:42:36
	135	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#12	2014-05-12 15:26:53
	134	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		DELETE usergroups#11	2014-05-12 15:26:29
	133		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 15:10:06	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 15:10:06
	132	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#11	2014-05-12 15:05:41
	131	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	first_name: A1 last_name: Admin name: A1 Admin	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 13:58:39
	130		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 12:42:22	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 12:42:22
	129		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 12:31:17	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 12:31:17
	128		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 08:25:27	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 08:25:27
	127	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#10	2014-05-09 16:32:05
	126		date_last_login: 2014-05-09 15:31:02	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-09 15:31:02
	125		date_last_login: 2014-05-09 11:55:33	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-09 11:55:33
	124	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	title: Sales	UPDATE usergroups#6	2014-05-09 11:18:51
	123	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#9	2014-05-09 11:18:40
	122	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#8	2014-05-09 11:17:41
	121	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	title: Sales team	UPDATE usergroups#6	2014-05-09 11:16:15
	120	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		DELETE usergroups#7	2014-05-09 10:50:01
	119	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	permissions: ADD: Full for usergroups#7 -- VIP	UPDATE departments#1	2014-05-09 10:24:49
	118	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#7	2014-05-09 10:23:52
	117	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	parent: null	UPDATE departments#2	2014-05-09 10:06:05

9.2. Managing agents

To help monitor how your agents are using the helpdesk, you can view a **Login log** below the **Agents** list.

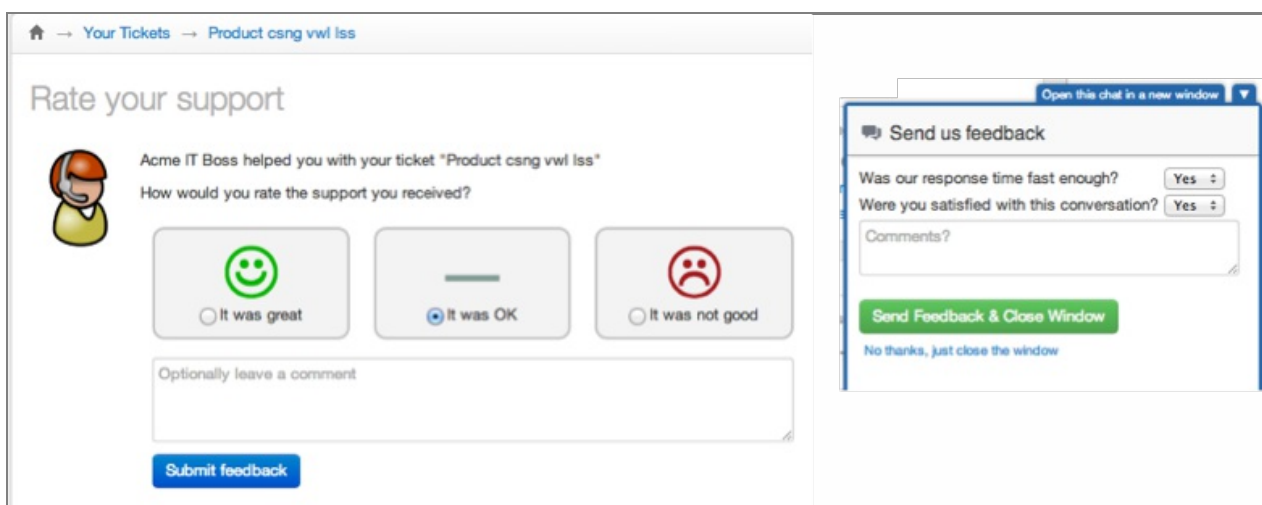
For more detailed information about agent activity, you can use the **Reports** interface, accessible from the chart icon at the lower left. DeskPRO's Reports system will be documented in a separate manual (forthcoming).

Satisfaction

To help measure agent performance, you can enable a **Satisfaction survey**.

This takes offers users the option to submit a brief rating and comment:

- when marking a ticket resolved through the user portal
- by going to a resolved ticket in the user portal
- after closing a chat



The image shows two user interface elements for feedback. On the left is a 'Rate your support' form. It has a breadcrumb trail: 'Home → Your Tickets → Product csng vw1 iss'. Below this is a title 'Rate your support' and a cartoon agent icon. The text says 'Acme IT Boss helped you with your ticket "Product csng vw1 iss"' and 'How would you rate the support you received?'. There are three rating buttons: 'It was great' with a green smiley face, 'It was OK' with a grey line, and 'It was not good' with a red frowny face. Below these is a text box for 'Optionally leave a comment' and a 'Submit feedback' button. On the right is a 'Send us feedback' chat window. It has a title bar 'Open this chat in a new window'. The content asks 'Was our response time fast enough?' and 'Were you satisfied with this conversation?', both with 'Yes' buttons. There is a 'Comments?' text box, a 'Send Feedback & Close Window' button, and a link 'No thanks, just close the window'.

You can access satisfaction data through the **Reports** interface.

9.3. User permissions

Usergroups determine what permissions users have. Usergroup membership grants user permissions, much like belonging to an agent permission group does for agents. Unlike with agents, there is no way to set permissions for an individual user.

Users can belong to multiple usergroups, and, as with agent permissions, the effect is additive; a user has all permissions that are granted by any of their usergroups.

You may want users who aren't logged in (**guests**) to be able to access some portal content. There is a special **Everyone** usergroup which grants permissions to guests. All the permissions you grant to **Everyone** will be available to every other usergroup.

You can edit usergroups from **Users > Permission Groups**

The special **Registered** usergroup grants permissions to all registered users. Every usergroup (apart from **Everyone**) will have the permissions you grant to **Registered**.

Another way to think about this is that **Registered** inherits all the permissions from **Everyone**, and your custom groups inherit all permissions from **Registered**. Permissions that are inherited are marked with a padlock, and can't be changed.

You can grant extra permissions on top of inherited permissions, but you can't take permissions away. For example, suppose you want to make a "Basic Users" usergroup which can't access chat. You must remove chat access from **Everyone** and **Registered**, and make sure that users in "Basic Users" aren't members of other usergroups which grant chat access.

For each portal function, you can enable/disable access for the usergroup entirely.

Note that this is distinct from using the Portal Editor to enable/disable sections altogether. If you disable access to a portal section for the **Everyone** usergroup, it won't be seen by any users, but it will still be visible to agents.

For each section, you can enable/disable a usergroup's ability to rate content and submit content visible to other users, such as comments and feedback items.

For permissions that involve user-visible content, you can also choose whether or not to require agent validation. This means that agents have to approve content to check it is not abusive, spam etc.

Incoming comments and feedback in need of approval will be shown under **Comments to Review** and **Feedback** in the agent interface:

PUBLISH	SEARCH	FEEDBACK	SEARCH
PENDING Comments to Review 1 Pending Articles 6 My Drafts 4 All Drafts 4		PENDING Feedback to Validate 3 Comments to Review 4	

9.4. User registration and authentication

User registration settings govern how users create new accounts. This includes details like how the helpdesk checks that the supplied email address really belongs to the user, and your user password policy.

These settings interact with the user permissions system which determine what users (and unregistered guests) can do. Some of the registration settings override certain aspects of the permission system.

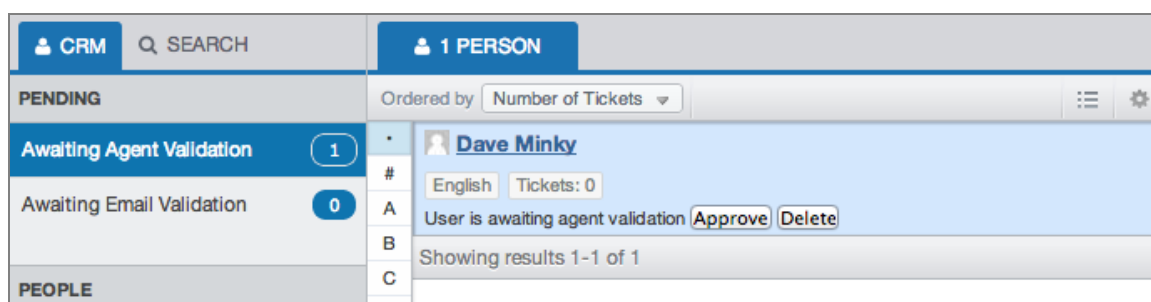
You can install **authentication apps** to let users or agents log in with credentials other than a DeskPRO account.

User registration settings

Go to **CRM > Registration** to change the helpdesk's settings for user registration and email validation.

The **Enable/Disable Registration** setting controls the ability for users to sign up for an account via the web portal. If you disable registration, agents must manually create an account for every user. Tickets submitted by email will only be accepted if the email From: address is already registered as a user's email address. Disabling registration gives you more control over who can access the helpdesk, at the expense of more time spent creating user accounts.

- **Require registration** hides any forms that a user can use to submit content: **Contact Us**, feedback and comments. If you enable this, even if the **Everyone** usergroup has the right permissions to submit content, the portal will not allow it.
- **Enable email validation for new registrations from the web portal** means that users who sign up for an account on your helpdesk must prove they own the associated email address before their account will work. This is done by sending a validation email with a special link that the user must click.
- **Enable email validation for new users submitting tickets from web** if this is not enabled, users can submit a ticket and provide any email address, even if it is not one they control; if it is enabled, the user must prove they own the email address by clicking a link in a validation email. Until the address is validated, the ticket is held in the **Awaiting Validation** filter in the agent interface. This option is useful if bots are submitting spam messages to your contact form. It also makes sure users have not made a mistake when entering their address.
- **Enable email validation for new users submitting tickets from email** it is easy for spammers to send email with a fake From: address. If this option is enabled, the user must prove their From: address is valid by clicking a link in a validation email. This option can help to prevent incoming spam email being turned into tickets.
- **Enable manual agent validation** means that your agents must approve every new account. Accounts that need approval will show up in the agent interface CRM app in the **Awaiting Agent Validation** filter:



While users are awaiting validation, they can still submit content, but it won't be shown on the portal until they are validated.

Password policy

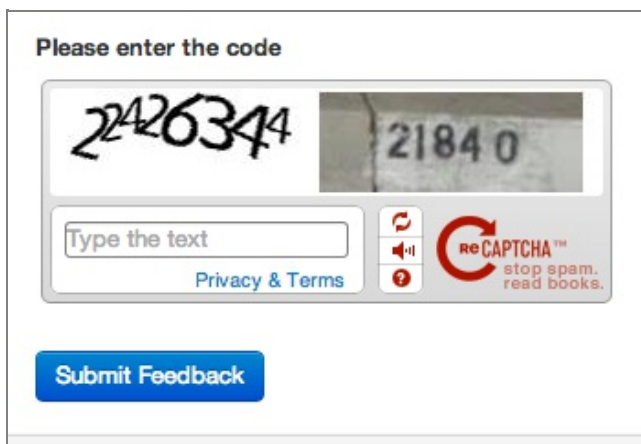
Go to **CRM > Password Settings** to set the requirements for creating account passwords. You can set separate requirements for agents and users.

Note that if you are using DeskPRO Download, agents with admin interface access need to use a special tool to reset their passwords.

CAPTCHAs

You can enable CAPTCHA tests on the portal. These require users to recognize text or audio to check that you are receiving input from a human user and not an automatic spam-posting program.

DeskPRO uses the [reCAPTCHA](#) system.



Go to **Portal > Settings** to enable CAPTCHAs. You can have CAPTHCAs:

- for user registration
- for new feedback items and comments

If you require CAPTCHAs for feedback and comments, you can choose whether even registered users need to pass a test for each comment.

Authentication apps

You can install **authentication apps** to enable users and agents to sign on with credentials from outside DeskPRO, instead of needing to create a DeskPRO account.

For example, you can allow agents to use their existing login information on your network, or allow users to sign in with their Facebook accounts.

See the section on [Extending DeskPRO](#) for more details.

10. Automating the Helpdesk

DeskPRO provides a number of ways to automatically process tickets. You can use these to have the helpdesk carry out routine procedures, leaving your agents with more time to focus on helping users. You can also set automatic rules to bring tickets to the attention of agents and help them identify urgent tickets.

- **SLAs** track your helpdesk's response time goals, and can perform actions on tickets when a goal is failed or close to failing.
- **Triggers** run actions when a ticket is created, replied to or updated. DeskPRO's built-in processes, such as sending out agent notifications and validating user email addresses, are controlled by triggers, and you can edit them to change how they behave.
- **Escalations** run actions on tickets based on the elapsed time the ticket has been in a certain state.
- **Macros** carry out a series of actions on a ticket when applied by an agent, automating repetitive tasks. Agents can create their own macros without admin access (unlike SLAs, triggers and escalations).

10.1. SLAs

SLAs (Service Level Agreements) enable you to set goals for ticket response time. These goals might represent an actual SLA with a client who is paying for support, or just an internal quality standard.

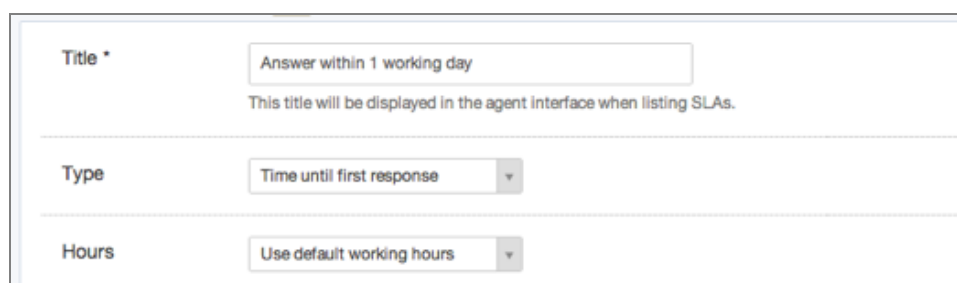
Tickets that are close to failing the goal (you define what is considered 'close') enter a **warning** condition, and tickets that exceed the goal have **failed**.

There are two effects of SLAs:

- 1 Tickets close to or failing an SLA are highlighted to agents: tickets on warning are edged amber, tickets that have failed are edged red.
- 2 SLAs can run automatic **actions** to modify the ticket on warning or failure.

Creating an SLA

Create a new SLA by going to **Tickets > SLAs** and clicking **Add**.



The screenshot shows a form for creating a new SLA. It has three main sections: 'Title', 'Type', and 'Hours'. The 'Title' section has a text input field with the value 'Answer within 1 working day' and a note below it stating 'This title will be displayed in the agent interface when listing SLAs.' The 'Type' section has a dropdown menu with 'Time until first response' selected. The 'Hours' section has a dropdown menu with 'Use default working hours' selected.

Set **Type** to decide whether the SLA tracks:

- time until first response
- time until ticket is resolved
- user waiting time until ticket resolution (total)

You can use **Hours** to set whether time should be counted **24x7** (continuously), during default working hours (as defined in **Tickets > Settings > Default Working Hours**), or during custom hours that you define.

For example, suppose your helpdesk's default working hours are set as 9am to 6pm Monday to Friday, and you have an SLA that requires you to make a first response within 8 hours. A ticket arrives at 5pm on Monday and doesn't get answered. If you have set **Hours** as **24x7**, the elapsed time will be counted all night, and the ticket will fail the SLA 8 hours later at 1am. But if you set the SLA to count **Default Working Hours**, elapsed time will only be counted until 6pm. Then the clock will stop until 9am the next day, when the remaining 7 hours will start counting down again.

SLA Warning

After hours the ticket is close to failing and the warning status is applied.

then The followings actions will run:

Set Urgency

then Set Assigned Team

Action

SLA Failure

After hours the ticket is close to failing and the failed status is applied.

then The followings actions will run:

Set Urgency
☒ Only set if urgency is lower

then Set Assigned Team

Action

Define an **SLA Warning** time (when the ticket is considered close to failing) and a **SLA Failure** time.

Note the value you enter in SLA Failure is the total time elapsed on the ticket, *not* the time since warning.

You can define actions that run automatically at warning and at failure. For example, you might want to increase the **urgency** of a ticket that is about to fail an SLA, or assign the ticket to a more experienced team.

Click the **+ Action** button under **SLA Warning** or **SLA Failure** to add **actions** that will run on warning.

SLA Application

Save

Use **SLA Application** to set which tickets are affected by the SLA:

- **Apply to all tickets:** this applies the SLA to all tickets created *from now on* (not existing tickets)
- **Agents manually apply the SLA:** agents apply the SLA from the **SLAS** tab of the ticket
- **Apply to new tickets that match certain criteria:** you can enter conditions that tickets must meet for the SLA to apply.

Click **Save** to store the SLA.

10.2. Ticket escalations

Ticket escalations run actions once a ticket has spent a set amount of time in a certain state. They are useful to ensure that tickets don't spend too long without attention from agents. For example, you can use escalations to increase the urgency of older tickets, or to automatically assign tickets that have gone unresolved for too long to a second level support team.

Create escalations from **Tickets > Escalations**.

When you create an escalation, you define what state a ticket must be in for elapsed time to count:

- **time the ticket has been open for** total time the ticket has existed without being resolved
- **time the user has been waiting** how long the ticket has been "awaiting agent", continuously since the most recent status change i.e. if the status is changed from "awaiting agent" and then back again, the clock resets
- **total time the user has been waiting** *cumulative* time the ticket has been **awaiting agent** over its whole life
- **time the agent has been waiting** how long the ticket has been "awaiting user", continuously; again, this resets if the status changes
- how long **the ticket has been resolved for** i.e. time elapsed since the ticket was resolved; this is useful if you want to delete older tickets or assign to a quality control team

You also define how long the ticket must spend in that state for the escalation to apply.

You can also set extra **criteria** that the ticket must meet for the escalation to run. For example, if you specify a department, the escalation will apply only to tickets in that department.

Criteria

Criteria that must match for the escalation to apply to a ticket.

if The following conditions are met:

Ticket Criteria

Status

Department

Agent

Agent Team

Product

Category

Priority

You then define the actions that run when the ticket has run up the correct elapsed time and meets any criteria.

Actions

then The followings actions will run:

Set Assigned Agent A-1 IT Boss

then Set Priority Urgent

then Set Flag Red

+ Action

Save

10.3. Ticket triggers

Triggers are automatic processes that can perform **actions** when a ticket changes.

Before a trigger runs, it checks against its **criteria**. The trigger's actions will only run when the criteria are met.

There are three types of triggers which can run under different circumstances:

- **New ticket** - checked when a new ticket is created
- **New ticket reply** - checked when an agent/user replies to a ticket
- **Ticket update** - checked when a ticket property changes

To create a new trigger, go to **Tickets > Triggers** and then either **> New Ticket**, **> New Reply** or **> Ticket Update**, depending on the type of trigger you want to make.

1

Specify a **Title** for the trigger that describes what it does.

2

You can further refine when a trigger runs using the **Event** section. You can choose to have the trigger checked only in response to changes by users or agents, and only in response to changes from certain interfaces (web, email or API).

For example, you have a "new ticket" trigger that is checked only when the ticket was created by a user via email:

Event

When a new ticket is created

☒ By a user ☐ By an agent

— ☐ via the web ⚙

— ☒ via email

— ☐ via the API

Click the gear icon next to **By a user > via the web** to further refine which web interfaces cause the trigger to be checked.

When a new ticket is created

☒ By a user

— ☒ via the web ⚙

☒ Portal ☒ Widget ☒ Ticket Form

— ☒ via email

— ☐ via the API

- **Portal** means the user web portal
- **Widget** means the Feedback and Support Tab widget (see under **Portal > Embed**)
- **Ticket form** means the embeddable Contact Form (see under **Portal > Embed**)

3

Set **criteria** which a ticket must meet before the trigger runs. These can be properties of the email, ticket, attachments, user, user's organization or the current time.

4

Criteria

The criteria section is a list of terms that must match before the actions are applied to the ticket.

or The following conditions are met:

User is new

Criteria

or The following conditions are met:

Department is Sales

Criteria

Set the **actions** which the trigger will run. Actions can be used to notify agents and users, or change the state of a ticket, or even trigger an API call to a web-based service.

Actions

These actions will apply when all of the criteria pass.

then The followings actions will run:

then Set Assigned Agent A-1 Sales Exec

Action

Editing triggers for built-in processes

The built-in helpdesk processes such as sending agent notification emails are controlled by triggers, which you can edit to change their behavior.

The triggers which control these built-in processes are:

New ticket:

- Enable/check email validation
- Check agent validation
- Replying by email assigns to that agent
- Agent notifications
- Auto-reply confirmation
- Notify user about new ticket by agent

New reply:

- Send agent notifications
- Send auto-reply confirmation to user
- Send user new reply from agent

Ticket update:

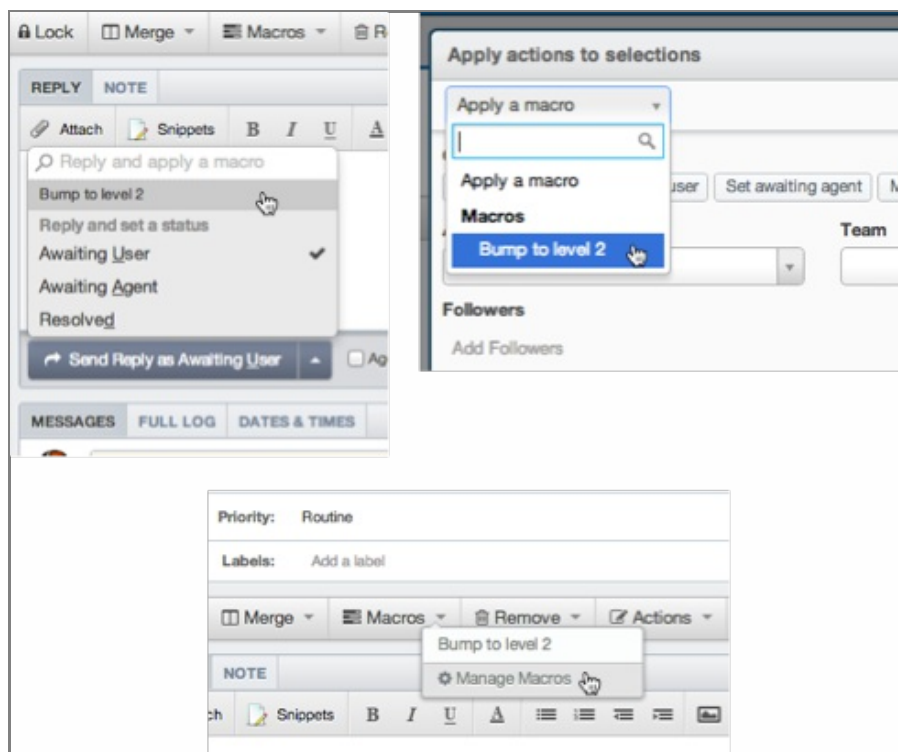
- Send agent notifications

10.4. Macros

Macros are stored sequences of actions which agents can apply from the agent interface. Macros are designed to automate sequences of steps that agents often have to repeat. An agent can apply a macro to a ticket with a couple of clicks. Using macros to perform commonly-repeated sequences of actions helps agents work more efficiently.

When a macro runs, the actions it contains are applied to the ticket it is run on.

Agents can apply macros from the content pane using the **Macros** button or the **Send Reply** control. They can also apply macros as a mass action from the list pane.



Macros can be shared (available to everyone), or limited to a specific agent. Note that if an agent tries to run a shared macro but lacks the permissions to run all its actions, the macro will not run.

Agents can create macros in the **Preferences** area of the agent interface. You can create macros from **Tickets > Macros**, where you can also edit agent macros.

To create a macro:

- 1 Enter a descriptive **Title** that makes clear to agents what the macro does.
- 2 Select a **Permission** level; the macro can either be shared or limited to a specific agent.
- 3 Click the **+ Action** button and select an action.
- 4 Keep adding actions until the macro is complete.
- 5 Click **Save**.

10.5. Using urgency to prioritize tickets

A common use of automation is to set the **urgency** score on tickets, to help agents decide which ones to deal with first.

Urgency is a score from 1 to 10. For a newly created ticket, it defaults to 1.

Actions can be used to increase or decrease urgency by a certain amount, instead of setting it to a particular value. This allows a number of different automated rules to be applied to a ticket, giving a combined urgency which reflects competing considerations.



For example, suppose your enterprise needs to encourage agents to prioritize tickets from the VIP usergroup, and to prioritize their support tickets over sales tickets.

You could set a triggers to increase the urgency for new tickets from the "VIP" usergroup by 6, and a second trigger running afterwards to decrease the urgency for new tickets in the "Sales" department by 3.

A new "Support" ticket from a VIP would start with urgency 1, get 6 urgency from the first trigger, for an overall urgency of 7.

A new "Sales" ticket from a VIP user would start with urgency 1, get +6 from the first trigger, then -3 from the second trigger, for an overall urgency of 4.

Urgency can never go below 1 or above 10. If an action would decrease a ticket's urgency to below 1 or above 10, it will be set to 1 or 10 respectively.

You can view the distribution of **urgency** values for your current unresolved tickets under **Tickets > Urgency**.



10.6. Actions guide

This section is a complete guide to the actions you can use in triggers, SLAs, escalations and macros.

Ticket Assignment

- **Set Assigned Agent:**
 - assign the ticket to an agent you specify, or
 - **Unassign** the ticket, or
 - assign to **Current agent** (the agent who activated the trigger - if the trigger was activated by a user, this action will be ignored)
 - **Set Assigned Team:**
 - assign the ticket to a team you specify, or
 - assign the ticket to **No Team**, or
 - assign to the **the Current Agent's Team** (the agent who activated the trigger - if the trigger was activated by a user, this action will be ignored)
 - **Set Agent Followers:**
 - add an agent you specify as a follower

Ticket Properties

- **Set Status:** set the ticket status from the built-in statuses
- **Set Department:** set the ticket's department
- **Set Product:** set the ticket's product
- **Set Category:** set the ticket's category
- **Set Priority:** set the ticket's priority
- **Set Workflow:** set the ticket's workflow
- **Set Urgency:**
 - **increase urgency** by an amount you specify
 - **decrease urgency** by an amount you specify
 - **set urgency** to a specified value
- **Set Subject:** set the ticket title to the specified value
- **Set Labels:** apply the specified labels to the ticket (specify them in a comma-separated list)
- **Set Flag:** apply the specified flag color to the ticket
- **Set Email Account:** set which ticket email account will send messages related to this ticket
- **Set CC'd Users:** enter user email addresses to CC:

Ticket SLAs

- **Set SLAs:** specify SLAs to apply or remove from the ticket
- **Set SLA Condition Status:** set whether the ticket is passing or failing any SLAs applied (regardless of elapsed time)
- **Set SLA State:** set whether the ticket is waiting or finished on any SLAs applied

Ticket Actions

- **Set Ticket User:** set the user associated with the ticket
- **Delete Ticket:** delete the ticket
- **Require User Email Validation:** set the ticket status to "awaiting validation" and send the user a link to confirm their email address
- **Call Web Hook:** send an HTTP request to a web service; see the section on [Calling web hooks from actions](#)

Trigger Control

- **Stop Processing Triggers:** don't run actions from future triggers (and SLAs/escalations) for this ticket; note that any actions below this one in the current trigger/SLA/escalation/macro will still run
- **Prevent Emails to User:** future actions which would result in sending an email to users about this ticket are ignored
- **Prevent Emails to Agents:** future actions which would result in sending an email to agents about this ticket are ignored

Custom Ticket Fields

- set values for any custom fields you have created

Custom Person (user) Fields

- set values for any custom user fields you have created

11. Chat

DeskPRO offers IM-style live chat to allow users to message your agents. Users can access chat from your portal or from a chat widget which you can embed into your website.

Use **Chat > Setup** to enable or disable the chat system altogether. This page also provides the code for embedding the chat widget - see the section on [Website integration](#) for details.

Note that by default, the chat widget (either on the portal or embedded) won't appear unless there is at least one agent signed into chat from the agent interface.

You can have chat **departments** which work much like ticket departments (although they are a separate system - i.e. creating a ticket department will not create a corresponding chat department). Manage them under **Chat > Departments**. You can use usergroups and agent permission groups to limit chat access by department. See the chapter on [Departments](#) for more details.

You can customize the information stored for a chat session using custom chat **fields**, under **Chat > Fields**. These work much like custom ticket fields.

You can also manage the **labels** that agents have applied to chats under **Chat > Labels**.

12. Extending DeskPRO

You can extend DeskPRO with **apps** to integrate your helpdesk with other services, or add new functions.

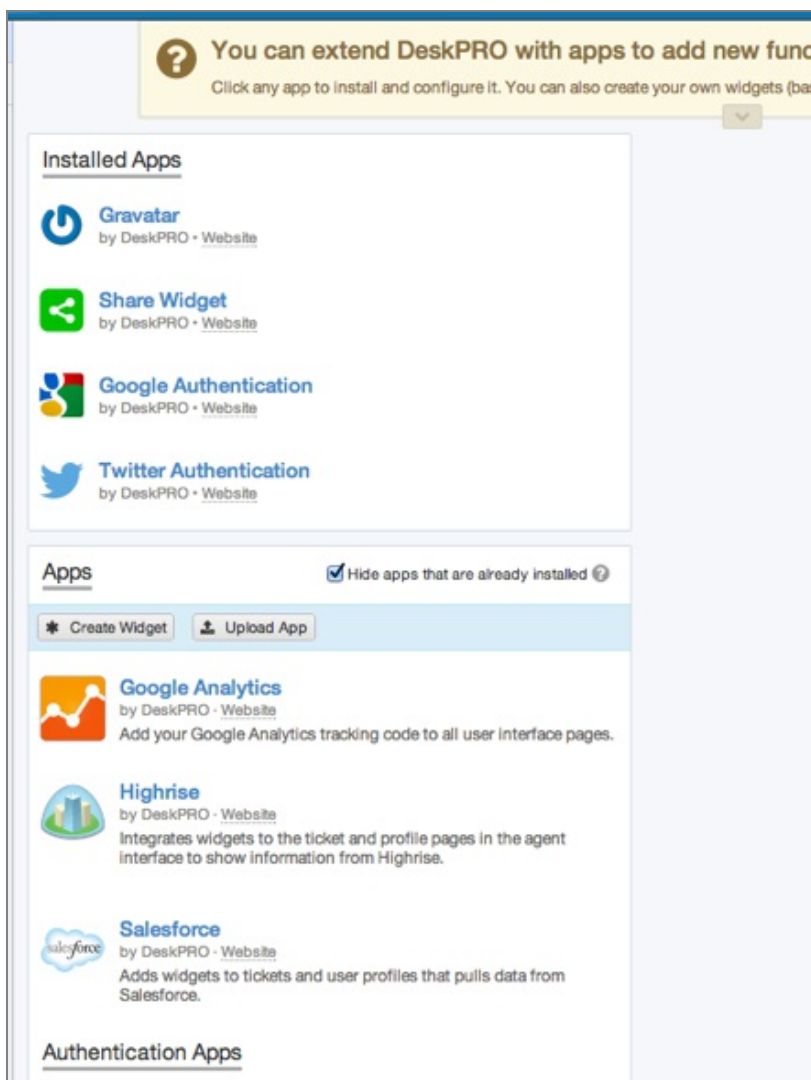
We have provided a number of ready-made apps, which you can quickly install. Some of these are **authentication apps** which enable agents or users to log in using credentials from other services, rather than a DeskPRO account. Others provide more extensive integration with other services.

We also provide two ways to develop your own apps:

- **widgets** are a simple way to customize the agent interface using HTML and Javascript
- **full apps** using the DeskPRO API require more development skills, but are more powerful

12.1. Installing the ready-made apps

We have provided a variety of ready-made DeskPRO apps to add new functionality and integration with other services.



Click on any app to install and configure it.

Most apps that operate with third-party services require you to set up an account with the service first. Some apps also require you to provide an **API token** or some other authentication code from the third-party service: consult the third-party support pages to find out how to get this.

12.2. Calling web hooks from actions

DeskPRO can use a **web hook action** (as part of a trigger, escalation, SLA or macro) to interact with external services that accept commands using the web's HTTP protocol.

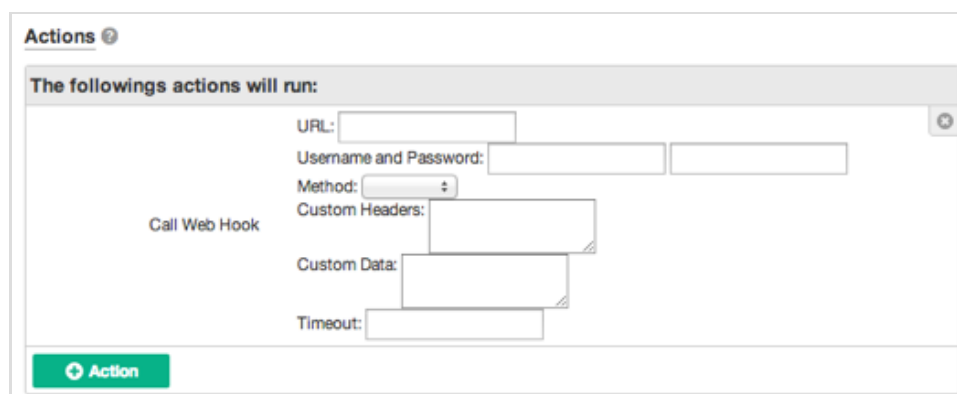
Many services offer HTTP APIs, so this provides a relatively simple way to have DeskPRO interact with other software you use (or software your enterprise has developed). For example, if a suitable API is available, you could post a warning on your intranet when a ticket fails an SLA, or send SMS notifications,

Note that this option can only send data from DeskPRO to an external service. If you want an external service to make something happen within DeskPRO, you will need to use the DeskPRO API.

To use web hooks:

1 Select the **Call Web Hook** action type.

2 Fill in the requested settings:



The screenshot shows the 'Actions' configuration window. At the top, it says 'The followings actions will run:'. Below this, the 'Call Web Hook' action is selected. The configuration fields include: 'URL:' with a text input; 'Username and Password:' with two text inputs; 'Method:' with a dropdown menu; 'Custom Headers:' with a text area; 'Custom Data:' with a text area; and 'Timeout:' with a text input. A green 'Action' button with a plus icon is at the bottom left of the configuration area.

You will need to consult the documentation for the software you are calling to find out the correct settings to use.

3 When the action runs, DeskPRO will make the specified HTTP request.

12.3. Generating DeskPRO API keys

Third-party apps which integrate with DeskPRO (including your own apps) will need a DeskPRO **API key** to gain access.

Bear in mind that anyone with access to one of your API keys can change data in your helpdesk, so you should be careful about who you share them with.

Go to **Apps > API Keys** to generate a key.

You can choose to generate a key that lets the app access your helpdesk as a specific agent account, or a key with "super user" permissions that will let the app act as any agent.

It's a good idea to make a separate key for each app you use. Delete a key if you want to permanently revoke access to an app. If a key has been compromised, you can regenerate it.

12.4. Creating your own apps

Use the **Create Widget** button under **Apps** to create widgets.

See the [Creating Widgets](#) article on the DeskPRO Knowledgebase for a guide to developing widgets.

See the **Apps Developer Guide** (forthcoming) for more details on how to create your own apps and widgets.

13. Other Settings

This chapter lists miscellaneous DeskPRO settings and configuration options.

13.1. Attachments and files

Users and agents can send files as attachments to ticket messages or via chats.

You can configure what sort of attachments are allowed from **Setup > Settings**

There are separate settings for agents and users. You can choose to allow all file types, or allow only files with specific **extensions** (e.g. .JPEG, .GIF, .DOC), or ban specific **extensions** (e.g. .EXE, .MSI).

You can set a maximum allowed file size.

Your server configuration limits the largest file size DeskPRO can handle. You should ensure that you don't allow files bigger than this.

See **Server Settings > File Uploads** for details of which settings affect the file size limit, and how to change it.

13.2. Automatic ticket locking

Confusion about who is working on a ticket is usually prevented by:

- 1 agent assignment
- 2 the ability for agents to see each other's draft messages

If an agent needs to prevent other agents changing a ticket, they can use the DeskPRO **locking** feature to manually lock it.

You can also enable **automatic locking** of tickets from **Tickets > Settings**, based on which agent has opened the ticket:

Ticket Locking ?

☐ **Automatically enable lock**
When enabled, a ticket will be automatically locked when an agent opens it in the agent interface.

☐ **Automatically release lock**
When enabled, the ticket will be automatically unlocked when the owner closes the ticket tab.

Lock timeout
The time a ticket can be kept locked to one agent before the system automatically unlocks it.

Automatic locking might be useful if you find your agents are duplicating work, or getting into disagreements about who is replying to a ticket.

The **lock timeout** is the period of time before the lock is automatically removed. It applies to both automatic and manual locks. This is necessary to prevent locks being left on too long (for example, if an agent locks a ticket and then forgets about it).

13.3. Managing labels

The **labels** system lets agents apply text tags to the following helpdesk content:

- Tickets
- Users
- Organizations
- Downloads
- News posts
- Feedback

These help with search and filtering of items from the agent interface.

There is a **Labels** management screen under the settings for each item.

You can add, rename or delete labels. This can be useful to correct misspelled or unhelpful label names.

13.4. Setting agent interface defaults

Under **Tickets > Settings > Ticket Defaults** you can configure the default values for agent interface inputs.

You can change these to reflect how your agents use DeskPRO. Pick defaults which reflect what agents do most often to increase their productivity.

For example, when an agent is replying to an unassigned ticket, the default is to assign it to that agent when the reply is sent, unless the **Agent** checkbox is cleared. If this default does not reflect how your agents use DeskPRO, you can change it.

Ticket message forwarding

Agents can forward individual ticket messages via email, using the gear icon to the right of each message.

Under **Tickets > Forward Settings** you can change which email account is used to send the emails.

By default, the forwarded email will appear to come from that email account's address, but you can choose to use the agent's address in the **From:** field instead. For this to work, you may need to configure your email server to accept messages with any **From:** address.

13.5. Importing data from legacy systems: Zendesk

If your enterprise previously used the Zendesk platform, and you are switching to DeskPRO, you can import your data from the Zendesk account.

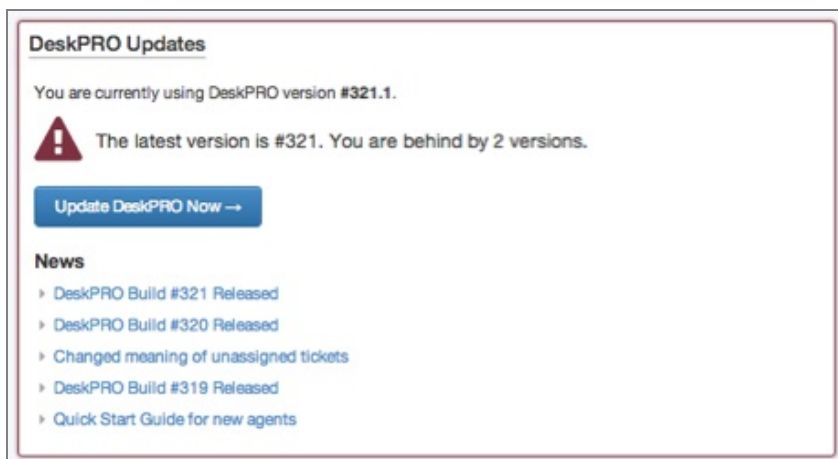
If you are using DeskPRO Download, you can import the data yourself using the Zendesk API. Please refer to the knowledgebase article [Importing from Zendesk](#) for details.

If you are using DeskPRO Cloud, please contact us at support@deskpro.com to arrange import.

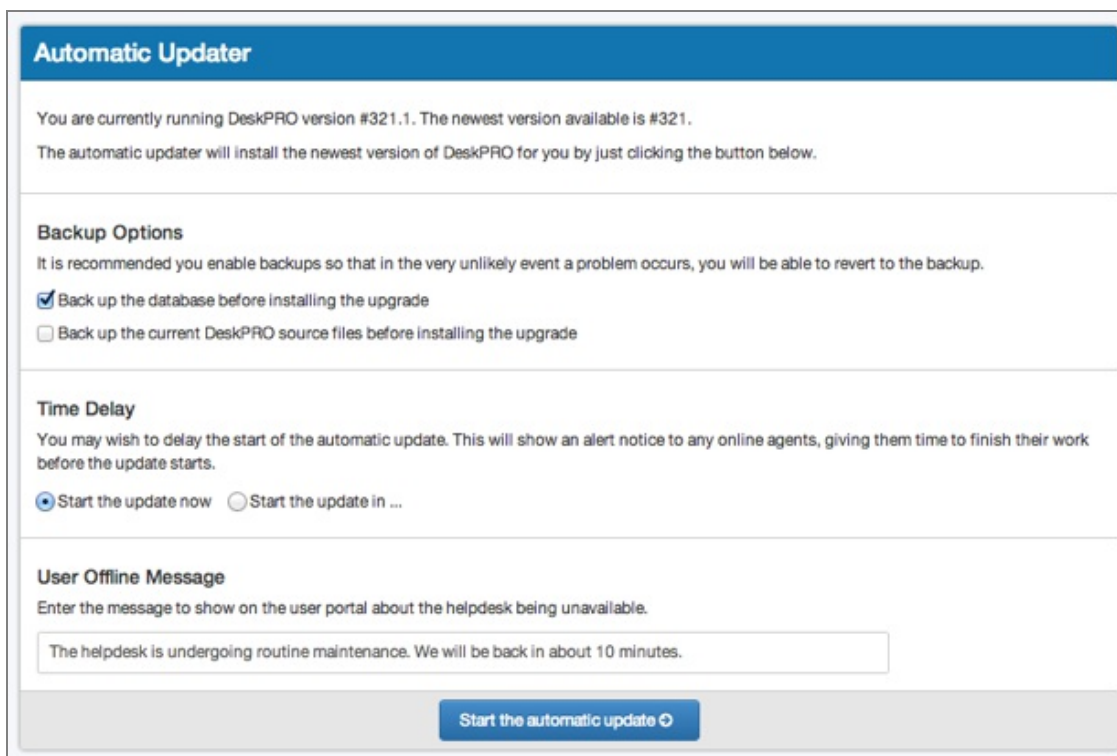
14. Updating DeskPRO

If you're using the Cloud version of DeskPRO, updating is automatic; you don't have to do anything to make sure that you have the latest version.

When an update for DeskPRO Download is available, you will be notified on the Home page. The best way to update is to use the automatic updater by clicking **Update DeskPRO Now**.



The automatic updater uses the cron/Scheduled Task system. This means the cron/Scheduled Task user must have write permissions on all DeskPRO files for the update to work. If there is a problem with permissions, you will be notified during the process.



The automatic updater gives you the option to back up the database and/or the DeskPRO source files, so you can revert to them in the unlikely event there's a problem.

You can also choose to set a time delay before the update begins. This option will show an alert to any agents who are using your helpdesk, so they know to finish their work. You can also use this to schedule the update for a time when there will be little usage of the helpdesk.

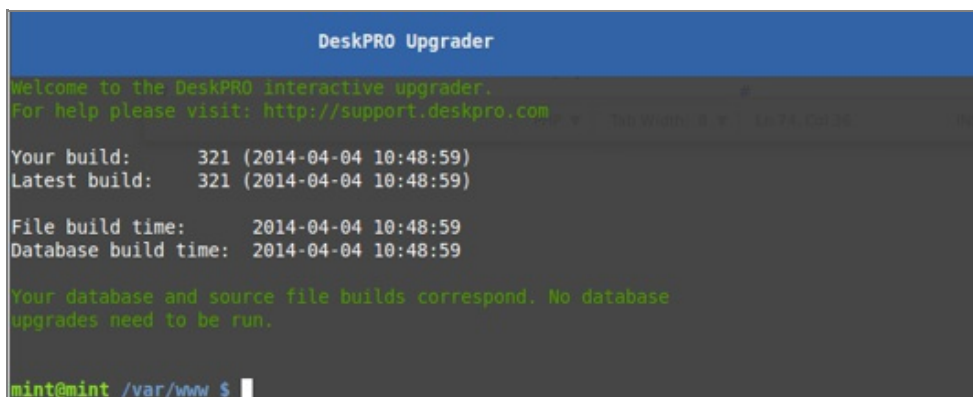
While the update happens, the helpdesk will be unavailable for a few minutes (depending on the size of your database). Under **User Offline Message** you can customize the notice that users will see on the portal during the update.

Command-line updater

If your configuration does not work with the automatic updater, you can use an interactive command-line utility.

From the directory where you installed DeskPRO, run:

```
php upgrade.php
```

A terminal window titled "DeskPRO Upgrader" showing the output of the upgrade script. The text is as follows:

```
DeskPRO Upgrader
Welcome to the DeskPRO interactive upgrader.
For help please visit: http://support.deskpro.com

Your build:      321 (2014-04-04 10:48:59)
Latest build:    321 (2014-04-04 10:48:59)

File build time: 2014-04-04 10:48:59
Database build time: 2014-04-04 10:48:59

Your database and source file builds correspond. No database
upgrades need to be run.

mint@mint /var/www $
```

The utility will guide you through the process of updating.

Manually installing updates

If the command-line updater does not work, you can manually update using the following steps:

- 1 Download the latest version of DeskPRO from <https://www.deskpro.com/downloads/deskpro.zip>.
- 2 Make a backup of the current DeskPRO files before you install updates in case you need to revert back.
- 3 Move the existing `data/` directory outside of the original DeskPRO install folder.
- 4 Copy your existing `config.php` to a safe place.
- 5 Extract the contents of `deskpro.zip` you downloaded in step 1, overwriting all existing files.
- 6 From inside the DeskPRO install directory, run the command-line upgrade tool:

```
php cmd.php dp:upgrade
```

The upgrade tool will ask if you want to produce a database backup before applying updates. We highly recommend you answer 'yes', in case you need to revert the upgrade.
- 7 The `data/` directory created in the install process may contain important log information, so copy it. Move the original `data/` directory from step 3 back into the DeskPRO install directory.
- 8 Move the original `config.php` file from step 4 back into the DeskPRO install directory.

15. DeskPRO Terminology

Admin: staff member within your company who has administrator access to configure and customize your helpdesk

Agent: staff member within your company who uses DeskPRO to provide help

Article: in the context of DeskPRO, an article refers to a piece of **knowledgebase** content

Assignment: a ticket can be assigned to an agent or a team to track who is dealing with that ticket

Chat: real-time instant messaging between agents and users; may be available to users from the web portal or integrated into a website

CRM: the app used for managing users and assigning them to **organizations** and **usergroups**; short for *Customer Relationship Management*

Downloads: useful files you provide to users through your web portal; e.g., software drivers or product manuals; maintained in the **Publish** app

Feedback: suggestions from users submitted through your **web portal**; e.g. a feature request or new product idea

Glossary: part of the **Publish** app used to maintain definitions of terms which are automatically displayed in **knowledgebase** articles

Knowledgebase: part of the **web portal** which contains rich-text help **articles**

News: part of the **web portal** which displays news posts chronologically; useful for product announcements

Organizations: used to track the company or other enterprise a user belongs to; you can assign users to organizations using the **CRM** app, or DeskPRO can automatically assign organizations based on user email addresses;

Permissions: settings which control what an agent or user can do with DeskPRO; your agent permissions are set by your admins and might, for example, prevent you deleting tickets; a user's permissions depend on their **usergroup**

Publish: the app used to maintain content for the web portal: knowledgebase articles, news posts, downloads and glossary entries

SLAs: short for *Service Level Agreements*; goals for dealing with tickets that your helpdesk aims to meet, e.g. that you must reply to a new ticket within 4 hours; shown in the **Tickets** app.

Snippets: short pieces of text which you can quickly insert into messages to users; useful to save time entering standard greetings, phrases, canned answers etc.

Status: a ticket's status is used to track who needs to act on a ticket next: **awaiting agent** means the helpdesk must do something related to that ticket; **awaiting user** means the helpdesk is waiting for the user to reply; **resolved** means the issue that ticket represents has been resolved

Tasks: an app used to track "to-do" items for agents

Teams: agents are grouped into teams to enable group ticket assignment

Ticket: represents a user question, problem or complaint; can be created automatically from incoming user email, or by a user from the **web portal**, or by an agent on a user's behalf

Ticket address: an email address that is linked to DeskPRO so that incoming emails are turned into tickets e.g. `support@example.com`

User: one of the people the helpdesk is trying to help

Usergroup: users belong to usergroups which determine what they are allowed to do and see when interacting with DeskPRO; created by admins, assigned with the **CRM** app

Web portal: the user-facing web interface of DeskPRO - can be integrated into your own website; help information on the portal is maintained using the **Publish** app